RazorCAD User Manual

Parametric parts, assemblies, sheet metal, structures and drawings

Software version 0.17.4-beta
Manual revision 2026-10-26

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1 Introduction

1.1 What RazorCAD is

RazorCAD is a parametric part modeller for Windows with a classic feature-tree interface. You build a part as a **feature history**: sketches, extrudes, revolves, cuts, fillets, patterns and so on, each of which can be edited later. Changing a dimension or an equation rebuilds every feature after it.

Solid modelling runs on the **OpenCascade** B-rep kernel (the engine behind FreeCAD), through the replicad library. Display uses three.js. RazorCAD runs fully offline.

Main capabilities:

- Constraint-driven 2D sketches with relations, dimensions and equations, plus gear and airfoil generators
- 3D sketches for frames, pipe and duct routes and sweep paths
- Solid features: extrude, revolve, sweep, loft, hole, helix, threads, wrap, draft, rib, dome, patterns, mirror, fillet, chamfer, shell
- Multi-body parts with combine, subtract, split, move/copy, per-body materials and appearances
- Surface modelling: extruded, revolved, planar, lofted, swept, filled, boundary and ruled surfaces, trim, extend, knit, thicken and more
- Sheet metal: flanges, hems, miter flanges, sketched bends, jogs, forming tools, tab and slot, lofted bends, transitions, flat patterns and DXF export
- **Fast Structure** (weldments): structural members from standard profiles, end caps, gussets, weld beads and a cut list
- Assemblies with mates (including gear and rack-pinion mates), sub-assemblies, configurations, standard parts and fastener sets, equations shared with the parts, holes and cuts made in the assembly, exploded views, motion studies, collision detection, an interference check, a bill of materials with mass and cost, and STEP export
- 2D drawings of parts and assemblies, with projected, section, detail, auxiliary, broken, exploded and flat pattern views, dimensions (also made automatically), GD&T, cosmetic threads, balloons, bill-of-materials tables, a drawing check, DXF drawings placed on the sheet, and PDF and DXF export
- Millimetres or inches, chosen for each document
- STEP, IGES, STL, OBJ and 3MF import; STEP, STL, OBJ and 3MF export; DXF import into sketches and drawings, and DXF export of faces and flat patterns
- Macros, recorded or written, that drive RazorCAD
- English, German, French or Spanish, a light or dark theme, and keyboard use of the panels
- An **Ask Claude** panel that builds features from a plain-language description
- A browser version at razorcad.com/app, the same program without installing anything

1.2 About this manual

This manual describes RazorCAD as it is in the version shown on the cover. It is checked against the software every day and updated when features change; Appendix C lists what changed in each revision.

The **Contents** and the **Index** are clickable. The footer of every page has a **Back to Contents** link. Your PDF viewer's bookmarks pane shows the same outline.

1.3 Conventions

Convention	Meaning
File ▸ Save	A menu command: the File menu, then Save
`Ctrl+S`	A key or key combination
Property panel	The panel on the left that holds a feature's settings while you edit it
Feature tree	The feature history list on the left
Command ribbon	The tabbed toolbar across the top (Features, Sketch, Surfaces …)
`width/2`	Text you type, such as a value or an equation

> **Note:** Lengths are in **millimetres** or **inches**, chosen for each document (see Units). Angles are in **degrees**.

2 Installing and Starting RazorCAD

2.1 Running RazorCAD

Double-click **RazorCAD.exe**. It is one standalone program: it needs no browser, Python or installation, and it runs offline. It uses the Microsoft Edge WebView2 runtime, which comes with Windows 10 and 11.

2.2 RazorCAD in your browser

razorcad.com/app runs the same RazorCAD in a web browser (Microsoft Edge, Chrome and other current browsers), with nothing to install: parts, sketches, assemblies, drawings and macros, on the same geometry kernel.

- **Open** reads a file from your PC and **Save** downloads it. Preferences stay in that browser.
- There is no auto-save, no Windows fonts (the fonts that come with RazorCAD are used) and no Ask Claude sign-in. A notice at the top says so and links to the Windows app; ✕ closes it for good.
- Parts that take a while to build are kept in the browser's own storage (up to 400 MB), so they open quickly the next time.
- Closing the browser tab with unsaved work asks first.

2.3 Installing with the setup program

Testers can be given **RazorCAD-Setup.exe**, a single setup program with RazorCAD inside it.

- Install for the current user (`%LOCALAPPDATA%\Programs\RazorCAD`, no administrator rights), for all users (Program Files), or into a folder you choose.
- Setup installs the Microsoft Edge WebView2 Runtime and .NET Framework 4.8 from Microsoft if they are missing.
- It creates Start-menu and desktop shortcuts and registers RazorCAD under Windows **Installed apps** with an uninstaller.
- The uninstaller asks before removing settings and crash reports. Part files are never touched.
- Running setup again updates an existing installation.
- Until RazorCAD is code-signed, Windows may show "Windows protected your PC" for the setup: click **More info**, then **Run anyway**. The *Read me first* file that comes with the setup says what to expect for that version.

Silent install and uninstall:

Command	Effect
`RazorCAD-Setup.exe /S`	Silent install for the current user
`/D=folder`	Install into this folder
`/ALLUSERS`	Install for all users
`/NODESKTOP`, `/NOSTARTMENU`	Skip the desktop or Start-menu shortcut
`uninstall.exe /S`	Silent uninstall

2.4 Updates

A little after it starts (at most once a day), RazorCAD asks GitHub for the newest RazorCAD release. When there is a newer one, a notice in the corner offers **Download** (the release page), **Later** or **Skip this version**. Nothing is shown when you are up to date or offline. Only GitHub is asked; nothing about you or your parts is sent.

Help ▸ Check for Updates... checks at once and says what it found. Its window also turns the check at start on or off. **Help ▸ About RazorCAD** shows the version you have.

Update Now (in the notice and in Check for Updates) updates in one click: RazorCAD downloads the new setup from its GitHub release, checks it against the release (size and SHA-256), installs it into the same folder (asking for administrator rights only when it was installed for all users), closes and starts again as the new version. Unsaved work is saved first (**Save All and Update**), or the update waits. If anything goes wrong, the version you had starts again. A copy of RazorCAD that wasn't installed with the setup offers **Download** instead.

2.5 The start window

At launch RazorCAD shows a start window with:

- **New to RazorCAD? Take the one-minute tour** (until you have taken it; see Getting Started Tour)
- **New Part**, **New Assembly** and **New Drawing**
- **Open...**
- **Sample Part**, a ready-made part to explore
- **Recent Parts**: name, folder and date. Missing files are greyed out and can be removed with ×. Parts that have an auto-save waiting are marked.
- **Recover Previous Session**, offered once when unsaved work from an earlier version is found
- A notice when new crash reports have been written

Reopen it any time with **File ▸ Recent Parts / Start...**.

2.6 The RazorCAD window

Area	What it does
Menu bar	File, Edit, View, Insert, Tools, Help. Next to the menus are quick buttons for **Save**, **Save As**, **Rebuild** and **Search commands** (the magnifier).
Document tabs	Each open part or drawing has its own tab. × closes a tab and asks to save.
Command ribbon	Tabs of tool buttons: **Features**, **Sketch**, **Surfaces**, **Sheet Metal**, **Fast Structure**, **Evaluate** and **Claude**. Buttons with a shortcut show the key in their bottom-right corner.
Feature tree	The part's history, with folders for Solid Bodies, Sheet Metal Bodies and Surface Bodies, the material, the planes and every feature. An eye column on the right shows or hides each item.
Configurations tab	Next to the Feature tree and the Property panel at the top of the left panel (see the Configurations chapter)
Property panel	Opens in place of the tree while you create or edit a feature. ✓ accepts (**Enter**), × cancels (**Esc**).
Heads-up toolbar	Above the 3D view: view orientation, display style, selection filters, visibility (eye button) and section view
Confirm corner	The top-right corner of the view holds ✓ / × for the active feature or sketch

Area	What it does
Status line and progress bar	Bottom left. Long operations (opening, rebuilding, importing, meshing, exporting) show progress here. The rebuild time is shown at the right; when features have errors it shows their number in red: click it for Fix References.
Units	Bottom right: **MMGS** (millimetres) or **IPS** (inches). Click it to change the document's units.

2.7 Customising the ribbon

The ribbon shows its buttons in two rows.

- **Icon size**: Small, Medium or Large, from **View** ▸ **Toolbar Icons** or by right-clicking the ribbon.
- **Rearrange**: drag a button to a new place; the others slide aside.
- **Your own toolbars**: click **+** after the tabs (or right-click a tab ▸ **New Toolbar...**). Add tools by dragging a button onto its tab or with right-click ▸ **Add to "..."**. Drag a button off to remove it.
- Right-click a button on a built-in toolbar to hide it or add a separator after it. **Customize Toolbars...** shows hidden buttons again, and **Reset** puts a toolbar back as it was.
- In **Customize Toolbars...**, choose **Sketch** and set **Sketch toolbar layout** to **Expanded (all tools)** or **Grouped (flyout menus)**. Grouped mode gathers lines, rectangles, arcs, splines and slots under their family buttons; click a family to select a variant. The preference is saved, and changing it preserves the expanded toolbar order and hidden tools. Use Expanded mode to rearrange individual tools.

The layout is kept in `prefs.json` in RazorCAD's data folder.

2.8 Settings

File ▸ **Settings...** or **Tools** ▸ **Settings...** (in parts, assemblies and drawings) has everything you can set in one place; a change applies at once:

- **Appearance**: theme, language, the size of the toolbar icons, and the Sketch toolbar's layout (all tools, or grouped in flyout menus).
- **Units and Axes**: the units of the part, assembly or drawing shown, and its up axis (also used for new parts).
- **Sheet Metal Gauges**: the gauges you saved (from a sheet metal feature's **Gauge** row, **Save...**); delete the ones you no longer want.
- **More Settings**: DXF Settings, Customize Shortcuts, Customize Toolbars, Claude Settings and the Getting Started Tour.

2.9 Language and theme

- **View** ▸ **Language**: English, Deutsch, Français or Español, in parts, assemblies and drawings. The menus, ribbons, Property panels, dialog titles and buttons, the tree's fixed items and the start window are translated; longer help texts and messages are still in English. The command search finds a command by its translated name or its English one. Macros, recordings and your shortcuts work in every language, and files are the same in all of them.
- **View** ▸ **Theme**: Light, Dark, or Follow Windows (switches when Windows does). In the dark theme the window, the 3D view and sketches are dark; drawing sheets stay white paper.

Both are kept with your preferences.

2.10 Getting Started Tour

A one-minute tour of the window in eight short steps, each pointing at its part of the window: the ribbon, the feature tree, the view and its mouse buttons, how to make a first part, the command search and the units. It ends with **Open the Sample Part**. Use **Next** / **Back** (or → / ← and **Enter**); **Esc** or **Skip the tour** ends it.

The first time RazorCAD starts, the start window offers it. If you close the start window on an empty part, it starts by itself, once. Afterwards it is in **Help ▸ Getting Started Tour**.

2.11 Search commands

Press **Ctrl+K** (or **/**), or click the magnifier next to Save, and type part of a command's name: "fil" finds Fillet, "circ pat" Circular Pattern. Pick a result with ↑ / ↓ and **Enter**, or click it.

- It searches every command of the menus and the ribbon of the document in front: part, sketch, 3D sketch, assembly or drawing.
- Each result shows where the command lives (its menu or ribbon tab) and its shortcut.
- With nothing typed, the commands you used lately come first.

2.12 Your own keyboard shortcuts

Help ▸ Customize Shortcuts... (or **Customize...** in Help ▸ Keyboard Shortcuts) gives commands keys of your own. Find a command, click **Set** and press the keys, for example **Ctrl+Shift+F**, **G** or **F6**.

- A shortcut works wherever its command is, in the document in front.
- It takes the place of a key RazorCAD uses itself; the window says when it does (for example **F**, Zoom to Fit). Giving a key to another command moves it there.
- **Esc**, **Enter**, **Tab** and **Backspace** can't be used.
- ✕ removes a shortcut; **Remove All** removes them all. Your shortcuts are listed at the top of Help ▸ Keyboard Shortcuts and shown in the command search. They are kept in `prefs.json`.

2.13 Using the keyboard

- **The trees**: click the feature tree, assembly tree or drawing tree, then ↑ / ↓ move from row to row (selecting as a click does), ← / → close and open folders, **Enter** opens the item as a double-click does, and **Home** / **End** go to the first and last row. While the tree has the keyboard, the arrow keys don't turn the view; click the view to give them back.
- **Property panels**: **Tab** goes through a panel's fields and buttons. The group headings are buttons: **Enter** or **Space** opens or closes them. The small ✕ / ▲ buttons in lists can be pressed the same way. **Enter** on a focused button presses it; elsewhere in the panel it accepts the feature, as before.
- **F6** / **Shift+F6** move the keyboard focus round the window: the Property panel (or the tree), the ribbon, the view.
- **Dialogs** take the focus when they open (their first field), keep **Tab** inside, and give the focus back when they close.
- **Screen readers**: every panel field is named by its label and unit (for example "Depth (mm)"), fields with an invalid value are marked so, and icon-only buttons are named by their tooltips. The status bar and panel messages are read out as they change, and errors at once.

2.14 Units

Each part, assembly and drawing is in **millimetres** or **inches**. Click **MMGS / IPS** at the right of the status bar, or use **Tools ▸ Units: Millimetres / Units: Inches**. Changing the units keeps every size exactly as it is; only how sizes are shown and typed changes.

In an inch document:

- Feature fields show and take inches. The arrow keys step 0.1 in (**Shift**: 1 in).
- Sketch dimensions, the Modify box and the sizes shown while drawing are in inches.
- Measure shows in, in^2 and in^3; Mass Properties also gives the mass in pounds.
- New features start at round sizes, to the nearest 1/8 in.
- Equation variables used in a length count in inches: with `w = 3`, a depth of `w/2` is 1.5 in.

Any value can name its unit: `2in`, `30 mm`, `1.5cm`, `2ft`, `(w/2)*in`. Values typed before a document became inch keep their size; an expression typed in millimetres shows as `(…)*mm`.

Drawings have units of their own (see the Drawings chapter). A drawing made from an inch part starts in inches.

3 Working with Files

3.1 Part files

Parts are saved as **.rcad** files, assemblies as **.rasm**, drawings as **.rdrw** and drawing templates as **.rdrt** files (see the Assemblies and Drawings chapters).

Command	Shortcut	Notes
File ▸ New Part	`Ctrl+N`	Opens in a new tab
File ▸ New Assembly		Opens in a new tab
File ▸ Open...	`Ctrl+O`	Opens parts, assemblies, drawings, templates, and STEP, IGES, STL, OBJ and 3MF files
File ▸ Open Sample Part		The built-in sample, in a new tab
File ▸ Save	`Ctrl+S`	Uses the normal Windows save dialog the first time
File ▸ Save As...	`Ctrl+Shift+S`	Saves a copy under a new name
File ▸ Properties...		The part's or assembly's custom properties (see below)
File ▸ Compare With...		Compares the part with another version of it (see below)

3.2 Properties

File ▸ Properties... in a part or assembly holds custom properties such as Part Number, Description, Vendor, Finish or Cost. Common names are suggested; any name works. Undo takes a change back. A drawing of the part takes its drawing number from the Part Number, bills of materials can show any property as a column, and the **Cost** property gives the cost columns (see Bill of Materials).

3.3 Compare With

File ▸ Compare With... compares the part in front with its last saved version, another part file, or another open part.

- **Features and settings**: features added or removed, features changed (with which settings: a depth, sketch points, an end condition, a new name), features moved in the tree, and the part's own settings (material, equations, units, configurations, properties).
- **Shapes**: both versions' volumes, and the material this version **adds** (shown yellow on the model) and **removes** (red), with their volumes.

3.4 Tabs and closing

Several parts and drawings can be open at once, each in its own tab. New, Open and Sample all open a new tab. Closing a tab with unsaved changes asks whether to save it, and closing RazorCAD asks to save every unsaved part.

3.5 Auto-save and recovery

Auto-save starts once a part has been saved for the first time. While the part has unsaved changes it is written next to the part file, at most every 20 seconds, as `Name.autosave.rcad`. The title bar shows the

time of the last auto-save. Saving the part removes the auto-save file.

If RazorCAD closes with unsaved changes, opening the part again offers to **recover** the auto-saved version. It is also marked in the recent list.

> **Warning:** A part that was never saved is not auto-saved. RazorCAD warns before closing it. Save new parts early.

The recent-files list is kept in `%APPDATA%\RazorCAD\recent.json`.

3.6 Opening from Windows and file previews

Double-clicking a .rcad, .rasm or .rdrw file opens it in RazorCAD; if RazorCAD is already running, the file opens in a new tab there. RazorCAD sets the file types up itself when it starts. **Help ▸ Open Files With RazorCAD...** shows whether they are registered and can register them again.

Saving keeps a small picture of the view in the file. Windows Explorer, the Open and Save dialogs and the start window show it as the file's thumbnail.

A part that takes a while to build is stored, once built, in `%LOCALAPPDATA%\RazorCAD\modelcache` (kept under 1 GB). With it the kernel keeps the geometry after each feature. Opening the unchanged file again shows the model at once, ready to edit: the first change after opening rebuilds only from the changed feature on, as any later change does. The store is kept for each version of the geometry kernel, so it survives RazorCAD updates that leave the kernel alone.

Each open part keeps a geometry kernel of its own, as many as the PC's processor threads and free memory allow (see Speed on your PC in the Troubleshooting chapter). Switching back to a part is then immediate, and a part still building goes on while you work in another tab.

3.7 Importing STEP, IGES, STL, OBJ and 3MF

There are two ways to bring in a STEP, IGES, STL, OBJ or 3MF file:

- **File ▸ Open...** opens it as a part of its own in a new tab, named after the file, without asking. A STEP file that holds an assembly asks first:
  - **Open as an Assembly** makes a new assembly with the file's structure: a sub-assembly for each of its sub-assemblies, a part for each part, and a component, fixed, where the file places each one. Each part keeps its own piece of the STEP file and is built on its own, and a part used several times is built once.
  - The first build of each part is kept on disk (in `%LOCALAPPDATA%\RazorCAD\modelcache`, up to 1 GB, shared with parts). The next time the assembly opens, unchanged parts are shown straight from there instead of being rebuilt, so a big assembly reopens in seconds.
  - **Open as One Part** brings every solid into one part, as before.
- **File ▸ Import STEP / STL...** (`Ctrl+I`, also on the Features tab, and **Import STEP / STL / OBJ / 3MF** on the Evaluate tab) offers three choices: a **new part**, **insert in place** into the current part, or **insert and locate with mates**. Locating with mates adds a separate "Locate ..." Move Body feature under the import.

How imports behave:

- The file's contents are stored inside the part file, so the part does not depend on the original file.
- A STEP file's appearances come with it: the colour of each solid and of single faces, and transparency. Your own Appearance and Make Transparent / Make Opaque settings on a body win over them.

- STEP imports as an exact solid. Every solid becomes its own body; a solid made of several separate shells is split into one body per shell; loose surfaces become surface bodies.
- The bodies of a multi-body STEP file are grouped in their own folder under Solid Bodies.
- Tick **Merge touching bodies into one body** in the import feature to fuse them instead.
- STL, OBJ and 3MF meshes are converted to a solid made of their triangles, with coplanar triangles merged. A 3MF file's units and build placement are read. A mesh that is not closed comes in as a surface body, with a note saying how many open edges it has; **Repair Mesh** or **Convert to Solid** (Surfaces chapter) can close it.
- Big meshes are simplified on import, by default to 80,000 triangles, keeping their edges and outlines. Set the limit in the import's properties (**Simplify meshes above … triangles**; 0 never simplifies). The import's note says how far a mesh was simplified.
- Imported bodies can be cut, extended, patterned and (for STEP) filleted like any other body. A cut or fillet on a body of more than 20,000 mesh faces warns that it can take several minutes.

IGES files (.igs, .iges) open and import like STEP files. Trimmed and bounded surfaces, B-rep solids, B-spline, plane, revolved, extruded, cylinder, cone, sphere and torus surfaces, lines, arcs, B-spline and composite curves and polylines are read, with the file's units and transformations. Faces that close up are sewn into a solid; the rest come in as surface bodies. RazorCAD translates IGES into STEP for the geometry kernel, which has no IGES reader of its own.

Volumes of bodies with B-spline faces (imported NURBS, IGES) are measured exactly.

3.8 Exporting

Command	Result
File ▸ Export ▸ STEP…	An exact B-rep. Each body is written as its own named, coloured solid.
File ▸ Export ▸ STL…	A binary mesh
Evaluate ▸ **Export OBJ** / **Export 3MF**	A mesh; 3MF is written in millimetres
Right-click a body ▸ **Export Body as STEP…**	One body only
File ▸ Export ▸ Face as DXF…	The outline of a flat face (see below)
File ▸ Export ▸ Flat Pattern as DXF…, Sheet Metal ▸ **Export DXF**	Flat patterns (see the Sheet Metal chapter)
Drawing ▸ **Export PDF** / **Export DXF**	Drawing sheets (see the Drawings chapter)

3.8.1 Export Face as DXF

Click a flat face, then right-click ▸ **Export Face as DXF…** (or **File ▸ Export ▸ Face as DXF…**). The face's outline (layer `OUTLINE`) and holes (layer `HOLES`) are written as a 2D drawing in millimetres, seen from outside the part. Use it for laser or waterjet cutting, or to take a profile into a 2D CAD program.

Lines, arcs and circles are exact; other curves become fine polylines. The file is DXF R12, which practically every program can read.

4 Navigating the 3D View

4.1 Mouse and keyboard

Action	Mouse / keys
Rotate (free, about the point under the cursor where the drag starts: a red dot shows it)	Middle-drag, or left-drag on the model outside a sketch
Pan	**Shift** + right-drag, or **Ctrl** + middle-drag
Zoom	Mouse wheel (toward the cursor), or **Shift** + middle-drag
Roll	**Alt** + middle-drag, or **Alt** + ← / →
Rotate in steps	Arrow keys 15°, **Shift** + arrows 90°
Pan in steps	**Ctrl** + arrow keys
Zoom to fit	**F**
Standard views	**Ctrl+1** … **Ctrl+7**
Normal To	**Ctrl+8** (press again to flip to the back side)

4.2 Standard views

View menu: Front (**Ctrl+1**), Back (**Ctrl+2**), Left (**Ctrl+3**), Right (**Ctrl+4**), Top (**Ctrl+5**), Bottom (**Ctrl+6**), Isometric (**Ctrl+7**) and Trimetric. **Normal To** (**Ctrl+8**) looks straight at the selected face or plane.

4.3 Up axis: Y or Z

A part can be shown **Y up** (the default) or **Z up**: **View ▸ Up Axis**, right-click **Origin** in the feature tree, or click **Y up** / **Z up** at the right of the status bar. With Z up the **Top plane is XY**, the **Front plane XZ** and the **Right plane YZ**, and Z points up; the tree shows each standard plane's axes beside its name. The choice is kept with the part and used for new parts too.

Only the names of the axes change: the model stays where it is and no feature moves. The triad, X / Y / Z directions, Move / Copy Bodies, reference point coordinates, Measure, Mass Properties and 3D sketch coordinates all use the part's axes, and so do exported STEP, STL, OBJ and 3MF files: a part shown Z up is written Z up, and a file imported into it is read Z up. The origin and corner triad always show X in red, Y in green and Z in blue: the vertical axis is green with Y up and blue with Z up.

An **assembly** keeps its own up axis in the same way (View ▸ Up Axis, the status bar, or right-click its **Origin** in the tree; Undo takes it back). Its tree shows the standard planes' axes, and a STEP file exported from an assembly shown Z up is written Z up. A new assembly starts with the up axis used for new parts.

4.4 Display styles

View menu or the heads-up toolbar: **Shaded With Edges**, **Shaded**, **Hidden Lines Removed** and **Wireframe**.

4.5 Visibility

- **View ▸ Show / Hide Planes** toggles the standard planes.
- The **eye column** at the right of the Feature tree shows or hides each sketch, plane, axis, point, curve, body and body-making feature on its own. Hiding a feature hides the bodies it built. Planes, axes, points and curves can also be hidden one at a time with right-click ▸ **Hide**.
- The **eye button** on the heads-up toolbar (or **View ▸ Visibility...**) filters what is shown: sketches, axes, planes, points and surfaces, with select-all and deselect-all.
- Right-click a body (tree or view) ▸ **Hide**. **`Tab`** hides the body under the cursor; **`Shift+Tab`** shows the hidden body under the cursor.
- **View ▸ Show Hidden Bodies** shows hidden bodies so you can click them to show them again. Choose **Done Showing Hidden Bodies** to finish.
- Right-click a body ▸ **Isolate** hides everything else. The isolated body can still be edited. **View ▸ Exit Isolate** returns.
- Right-click a body, or any feature that made or changed it, ▸ **Make Transparent / Make Opaque**. Transparency is saved with the part and can be undone.

4.6 Section view

Tools ▸ Section View... (or the Evaluate tab) cuts the model open on a plane so you can see inside. Choose the plane, an offset (equations are allowed) and flip the side kept. With a flat face, a plane or a sketch selected when you start, the cut starts on it; while the panel is open, click a flat face or a plane to cut from it instead. Drag the blue arrow on the cut to move it along its normal (the offset follows, in round steps; looking straight along it, drag up to bring it toward you). Tick **Section 2** (and **Section 3**) to cut with two or three planes at once: only what all of them cut away is removed, e.g. a quarter cut. The arrow and a click in the view move the section you changed last. It works the same in assemblies (Evaluate ▸ Section View): every component is cut and capped, and a click on a component's flat face cuts from it. ✓ keeps the cut on while you work; the Section View button then opens the panel again, and ✗ removes the cut. Saved with a cut on, a part or assembly opens with it again, and each tab keeps its own cut. Each cut body or component gets its own cap in its colour, outlined and hatched with section lines; the hatch angle and spacing change from body to body so touching parts read apart. Section View can't be used inside a sketch.

5 Selecting

5.1 Selecting in the part

A click selects what is under the cursor, in this order: a **vertex**, then an **edge**, then a **face**, then a **plane**. **Ctrl**+click adds to the selection.

5.2 Selection filters

The filter buttons on the heads-up toolbar limit what can be picked. Several filters can be on at once, and they also apply while picking references for features.

Filter	Key	Picks
Faces	**X**	Model faces
Edges	**E**	Model edges
Vertices	**V**	Corners (edge end points)
Solid Bodies	**B**	Whole bodies (a click on any face picks its body)
Planes		Standard and reference planes
Clear filters	**F5**	Back to picking anything

5.3 Quick readout of sizes

Clicking an edge shows a small tag in the view: its length, R and length for an arc, or Ø and circumference for a circle. **Ctrl**+click more edges for their total length (the perimeter when they go all the way round). Sketch entities shown in the view can be clicked the same way.

One face shows its area (and Ø when round). **Ctrl**+click a second face for how they lie: "Parallel · 12 mm apart", "Perpendicular · 90°" or the angle; two round faces give their centre distance; three or more faces their total area.

5.4 Highlighting from the tree

Hovering a feature in the Feature tree highlights what it made in orange: the faces of a boss, cut, fillet, chamfer, shell, pattern or moved body; a sketch's curves; a plane, axis or point; a surface feature's surfaces. Clicking it keeps the highlight in blue while it is selected.

5.5 Selecting hidden bodies

Hold **Shift** and **right-click** to step through the bodies and surfaces under the cursor, front to back; **Shift** + left-click steps back. The current one is shown in orange, through whatever is in front of it. Release **Shift** and **left-click** on the same spot to select it. **Esc** or a click elsewhere cancels.

- With only the face filter on, or while a Property panel asks for faces (Shell, Offset Surface), it steps through faces instead.
- While a Property panel asks for bodies (Combine, Split, Move/Copy, Knit, Thicken), the click adds the body.

5.6 Right-click menus

Right-click on	Offers
A face	Sketch, Normal To, Export Face as DXF, Fillet, Chamfer, Appearance…
An edge	Fillet, Chamfer (started with that edge), Reference Axis
A vertex	Reference Point
A face, edge or body	Body Properties, Body Appearance…, Export Body as STEP, Hide, Isolate, Make Transparent, folder commands
A sketch in the tree	Edit, Show / Hide, Change Sketch Plane…
A sheet metal body	View Flat Pattern, Export Flat Pattern as DXF
Empty space	Show Hidden Bodies, Measure and view commands

6 Sketching

6.1 Starting and ending a sketch

Click a plane or a flat face, then click **Sketch** (Sketch tab), or right-click a face ▸ **Sketch**. Clicking a sketch tool such as **Circle** with no sketch open also starts a 2D sketch: pick a plane or flat face and the tool is ready. (For sketches in space, see the 3D Sketches chapter.) You can also start a feature such as Extrude without a sketch: RazorCAD asks you to pick a plane or face, you sketch, and when you exit the sketch the feature continues. If the profile is open you can keep editing or abort and keep the sketch.

- **`Esc`** ends the active sketch tool first; pressing it again closes the sketch and keeps it.
- **`Enter`** does **not** leave the sketch.
- The ✓ in the confirm corner, or **Exit Sketch**, closes the sketch.
- **`Ctrl+Z`** / **`Ctrl+Y`** undo and redo inside the sketch.

6.2 The sketch tool wheel

While sketching, press and hold the right mouse button. After a moment, or as soon as you start to drag, a wheel of sketch tools appears around the pointer. Keep the button held, move toward a tool (it highlights) and release to activate it. Releasing in the centre or pressing **`Esc`** cancels. A quick right click (press and release without moving) still opens the right-click menu.

6.3 Defined and under-defined sketches

Sketches are made of points, lines, arcs and circles held in place by **relations** and **dimensions**. A numerical constraint solver keeps them satisfied.

- Geometry is **blue when under-defined** and **black when fully defined**.
- The Property panel shows the remaining degrees of freedom.
- An under-defined sketch shows **(-)** in the tree. Construction lines only need to be positioned. To rename a sketch, right-click its tree item and choose **Rename**, including when it has the **(-)** marker.

6.4 Sketch orientation

In the sketch Property panel, **Rotate 90°** turns the sketch axes about the sketch normal, and **Flip Side** looks at the sketch from the other side of the plane. Both are saved with the sketch.

6.5 Sketch tools

Tool	Key	How it works
Select	**S**	Select entities, drag geometry
Line	**L**	Click a chain of points. Coincident, horizontal and vertical relations are added automatically; snapping to a midpoint or onto a curve adds those relations too. Double-click, **`Enter`** or **`Esc`** ends the chain.
Centerline		Construction line for symmetry, mirroring, gears or as a revolve axis
Midpoint Line		Midpoint, then one endpoint; the opposite endpoint is mirrored and a Midpoint relation preserves the centre
Corner Rectangle	**R**	Built with horizontal and vertical relations

Tool	Key	How it works
Center Rectangle		Also adds construction diagonals with a midpoint relation
Circle	C	Centre, then radius
Centerpoint Arc	A	Centre, start, end; the direction follows the mouse
3 Point Arc		Start, end, then a point it runs through
Tangent Arc		From the end of a line or arc, kept tangent by a Tangent relation
Ellipse		Centre, end of the major axis, then the minor radius. Trim it for an elliptical arc.
Fit Point Spline	N	Through fit points, with editable tangent direction and strength handles; see below
Point		Lone sketch points that stay, for example to place holes
Straight Slot		Built with tangent and equal relations
Center Point Slot		Slot midpoint, one end-arc centre, then width
Overall Slot		Two outermost points along the axis define total length; the third click defines width
Center Point Arc Slot		Centre of the path arc, start centre, end direction, then width
3 Point Arc Slot		Start centre, end centre, third point on the centre arc, then width
Polygon	P	Set the number of sides in the Property panel
Dimension	D	See below
Trim	T	See below
Extend		A line or arc end runs on to the first entity in its way and stays on it
Split		Splits a line or arc in two at the click; the halves stay collinear or equal
Project Edges	E	See below
Offset	O	See below
Mirror		Select the entities plus a centerline, then click Mirror
Import DXF		See below
Linear Sketch Pattern		Opens a side panel with an orange preview. Select source entities before or after opening it, then choose an angle, line or curve as direction/path. Copies stay linked to their sources, path, quantity and spacing. Along a curve, spacing is measured along it and copies can rotate with it; open paths stop at their end. A straight direction also supports a second direction.
Circular Sketch Pattern		Copies the selected entities with the relations and dimensions among them. A selected point is the pattern's centre.
Make Block / Insert Block		Make Block saves the selection (with its relations) under a name in your settings. Insert Block places copies with a click, in any sketch, and can delete blocks from the library.
Text		See below
Gears		See the Gears chapter
Airfoil		See the Airfoils chapter

Tool	Key	How it works
Sketch Fillet / Sketch Chamfer		Set the radius or distance, then click corners (a fillet: where two lines, a line and an arc, two arcs, or a fit-point spline and a line or an arc meet: the spline is cut back to the fillet, which stays tangent to it; a chamfer: two lines). The first one made gets the dimension; the others made before you leave the tool are made Equal to it, so one value changes them all.
Intersection Curve		Click earlier sketch curves to create linked intersections with the active sketch plane, or select a model section
Construction Geometry	`Q`	Toggles selected curves to/from construction; with no curves selected, toggles construction mode for newly drawn geometry. The drawing panel also has **For construction**. Preview and resulting geometry are dashed and ignored by features.
Display Relations		Shows or hides the relation glyphs
Delete	`Del`	Deletes the selected entities or relations

Linear patterns and patterns along a path: confirm with the checkmark, or cancel with the cross (Enter / Esc also work outside input fields). The preview does not change the sketch until confirmed. Use **Sketch Patterns ▸ Edit Pattern** in the sketch Property panel to change sources, path, count, spacing or rotation later; count and spacing accept expressions. Edit original geometry to change the copies' shapes. Copies are linked and cannot be independently dragged; deleting a source, path or generated entity removes that pattern's copies. Parameters and links are kept with the part and follow undo/redo and rebuilds.

Patterns made by earlier versions were independent copies and contain no stored pattern definition. Recreate them with the updated command to obtain a parametric pattern.

Pattern copies use the defined-geometry colour: black in the light theme and light in the dark theme. Purple identifies projected geometry; the pattern preview is orange.

Fillet corners can share one endpoint or have endpoints joined by Coincident relations. If exactly two regular lines/arcs meet at a corner, construction geometry there is ignored when choosing the curves to fillet. An invalid radius leaves the sketch unchanged.

6.6 Dimension

Click a line, circle or arc (or two entities), then click to place the dimension.

You can also select a curve or two entities before starting **Dimension**. Move the pointer to position the orange preview, then click to confirm; the dimension is not created until that click. Press **Esc** to cancel the pending dimension. The text is placed at the point you choose.

With **Select** or **Dimension** active, drag a dimension's number to reposition its annotation without changing the measured geometry or value. A plain click still opens the value editor. This also works for driven/reference dimensions; placement is saved with the sketch and follows undo/redo. Press **Esc** during a drag to cancel the move.

Linear dimension text follows the dimension line and stays upright. Extension lines leave a small gap at the geometry and run slightly beyond the dimension line; short dimensions use outside arrows. For a point-to-line distance, dragging the text also moves the perpendicular dimension line along the reference edge. This lets a short horizontal offset such as 4 mm and an inclined perpendicular offset such as 13 mm use conventional drafting layouts without changing what they measure.

- Moving the mouse switches between horizontal, vertical and aligned.
- Two lines give an angle; a point and a line give a perpendicular distance.

- Values accept equations, such as `width/2`.
- A dimension that would over-define the sketch is added as a driven (reference) dimension.
- **Circles and arcs:** dimension from a circle or arc to another circle, arc, point or line by clicking both. The Modify box offers **Center** (centre to centre), **Min** (nearest) and **Max** (farthest). Min also measures the gap between concentric circles. Switching keeps the geometry in place and shows the new value.
- **Outside references:** you can also click model edges, model vertices or entities of earlier sketches. RazorCAD creates linked construction geometry and dimensions to it, so the dimension follows the model. Example: "keep this hole 25 mm from the right edge" still holds after the width changes.

6.7 Trim

Power trim: hover over a segment and it turns red; click to remove it up to the nearest intersections. Lines are shortened or split, circles become arcs, and new end points get on-curve relations.

6.8 Offset

Click a line, arc or circle and its whole connected chain is offset. Move the mouse to the side and distance you want and click, then type the exact distance. Corners are re-trimmed or extended.

- You can also click a **model edge** (with **Select chain**, the connected edges lying in a plane parallel to the sketch, such as a face outline) or a curve of another sketch.
- **Linked offset** (default): the offset follows its source, including model edges when the model changes, and one dimension drives the chain (relation "Offset ⇉").
- Untick it for a **single offset**: plain geometry with no link.
- While the tool is active, the faces the sketch plane cuts are highlighted and the cut outline is drawn in teal. Clicking it offsets the whole outline.

6.9 Project Edges

While editing a source sketch, sketches that depend on it are temporarily hidden to avoid displaying outdated projections over the current geometry. They return after leaving the sketch and rebuilding; independent reference sketches remain visible and the saved visibility settings are unchanged.

If a source edit such as a fillet separates formerly joined endpoints, their projected endpoints separate on rebuild while retaining their source links.

Splines projected from another sketch remain linked splines, preserving their control points, degree and weights. Earlier projections saved as line segments retain that representation.

Click a model edge, or an entity of an earlier sketch, to project it into this sketch. Or select edges first and then click **Project Edges** (or press **E**): they are projected at once. Projected geometry is drawn in **purple**, is linked and updates when the source changes (relation "On Edge ⇲"). The ends of projected lines are joined to each other and to sketch geometry already there, so the edges of a face give a closed outline ready to extrude. While the tool is active, the outline where the sketch plane cuts the bodies is drawn in teal; clicking it converts the whole outline. This works for solids and surfaces.

6.9.1 Selecting source sketches for Project and Intersection

While editing a sketch, activate **Project Edges** or **Intersection Curve**. Earlier independent sketches are temporarily shown, including hidden and absorbed sketches; their saved visibility does not change. Click the source curves in the canvas (orbit the view if they overlap). Project creates linked projected geometry. Intersection creates linked points where source lines, arcs or circles cross the active plane; coplanar curves

retain their geometry. Use the points as guide endpoints. Non-coplanar spline intersections are not yet supported. For solid/surface sections, click the displayed section outline. Escape returns to Select.

6.10 Spline

New **Fit Point Splines** include a tangent handle at each fit point. Drag a handle to change tangent direction and strength; adjacent pieces keep the same tangent through their shared fit point. Dragging a fit point carries its handle with it. Handle lines are construction geometry and accept ordinary line constraints and dimensions (for example horizontal, parallel, length or angle). Their remaining freedoms count towards sketch definition. Copies, mirrors, blocks, patterns and linked projections preserve the handles. Existing saved splines retain their previous representation.

Tangent handles are shown with solid teal stems, small direction arrows and round grips. Fit points use square markers. Selection names identify **Tangent Handle** and **Tangent Handle Line**, so these controls can be distinguished from ordinary construction centre lines.

Click the points the curve runs through (they snap like line points), then double-click, **`Enter`** or **`Esc`** to finish, or click the first point again to close it. Drag a point to reshape the curve, or drag the curve to move it; deleting a point takes it out of the spline. **Convert to Control-Point Spline** (in its panel) makes it a control-point spline that runs through the same points. Splines make profiles on their own or with lines and arcs and are exact curves for extrudes, revolves, cuts, lofts and sweep paths. Lines can be trimmed where they cross a spline.

6.11 Control-Point Spline

Control-Point Spline (beside Spline) draws a spline from control points: click them, then double-click, **`Enter`** or **`Esc`** to finish (click the first point again to close it: it then runs round smoothly, with no join). An open one starts and ends on the first and last control points and passes near the others; a closed one passes near them all. The **Closed** box in its panel opens or closes it. Choose the **degree** (1 to 7) in the panel before drawing, or select the spline afterwards to change it (at most one less than the control points): a higher degree is smoother and keeps farther from the polygon. The control polygon is drawn dashed and is made of construction lines, so you can dimension it and give it relations like any lines: horizontal, parallel, equal, an angle. The curve leaves each end along the polygon's end leg, so a relation on that leg (tangent to an arc, collinear with a line) sets its direction there. Drag the control points to reshape it. Deleting the spline deletes its polygon.

Select a control point for its own settings. **Weight** (1 is plain) pulls the curve toward that point when larger and lets it go farther when smaller: with three control points at the corners of a square, degree 2 and a weight of 0.7071 on the middle one, the curve is a quarter circle (to within 0.00001 mm). **Insert After** adds a control point half way along the next leg (the curve changes shape a little); **Remove**, or deleting the point, takes it out and joins its two legs.

6.12 Import DXF

Import DXF brings a DXF file into the open sketch: lines, arcs, circles, polylines with arcs, ellipses and elliptical arcs, splines, points and blocks. The file's units are converted to millimetres. You can scale it and place it as in the file, centred, or by its corner.

6.13 Text

Click **Text** on the Sketch tab, then click to place. The panel sets the text, font (the PC's installed fonts, and the DejaVu Sans, Sans Mono and Serif fonts that come with RazorCAD), height (capital-letter height),

angle, bold and italic. A font a PC doesn't have is drawn in the DejaVu font most like it. Drag the text to move it. Text extrudes as a boss or cut; text inside an outline is cut out of it. To put text on a curved face, use **Wrap** (Features chapter).

6.14 Relations

Select entities (**`Ctrl`**+click for several, or drag a box from empty space: left to right selects what lies wholly inside it, right to left whatever it touches; **`Ctrl`** or **`Shift`** adds). The Property panel lists the relations that apply:

Selection	Relations offered
1 line	Horizontal, Vertical, Fixed
2 or more points	Coincident, Horizontal, Vertical
2 or more lines	Parallel, Perpendicular, Collinear, Equal, Horizontal, Vertical
Point + line	Coincident (on line), Midpoint
Point + arc	Coincident (on curve), Midpoint (half way round the arc)
Point + circle	Coincident (on curve)
Line + circle/arc	Tangent
Circles/arcs	Equal Radius, Equal Curve Length, Concentric, Tangent
2 or more curves (including splines, ellipses or mixed line/curve selections)	Equal Curve Length; for lines only, use Equal
2 points + line	Symmetric (about the line)
3 lines	Symmetric (two lines about a centerline)

Relations are shown as small green glyphs next to the geometry. Click a glyph to select it, then press **`Del`** to remove it. Hovering a glyph highlights the entities it ties together. For several selected entities, relations already implied by existing constraints are skipped while useful relations are added. A relation refused says why: one that is **already satisfied** names the relations that already define the geometry that way (an information message); one that **would over-define** the sketch names the relations or dimensions in its way. Either way those relations are selected, so you can delete one and add the new relation instead. A true conflict rejects the entire request without changing the sketch.

Equal Curve Length (≋) constrains the length measured along each selected curve, not its chord or control polygon. Two arcs may have different radii and sweeps while keeping equal lengths; a spline can also match a line or another curve. Select the curves with Ctrl and choose **Equal Curve Length** in **Add Relations**. With more than two curves, each is matched to the first. Circular curves' **Equal Radius (=)** keeps their radii equal and remains a separate relation. Length links survive source edits, undo/redo, save/reopen and rebuild. Ellipse and spline lengths are integrated numerically from their definitions.

6.15 How profiles are found

Profiles are found automatically from all non-construction geometry and sent to the kernel as exact lines, arcs and circles. Intersections are split, dangling lines are ignored and nested loops become holes. A full circle (or arcs that make one) becomes a single closed curve, so an extruded circle has one continuous cylindrical face.

6.16 Showing and hiding sketches

Sketches absorbed by a feature are hidden by default. Right-click a sketch in the tree ▸ **Show / Hide**, or use its eye in the tree.

6.17 Change Sketch Plane

Right-click a sketch ▸ **Change Sketch Plane…** and pick another plane or flat face for it, for example to repair a sketch whose plane was deleted ("The reference plane is missing"). Its curves keep their sketch coordinates. Only planes above the sketch in the tree are offered.

7 3D Sketches

A **3D sketch** holds lines, arcs, circles and splines in space rather than on one plane. Use it for frames (see the Fast Structure chapter), pipe, duct and wiring routes, and sweep paths.

7.1 Starting and ending a 3D sketch

Click **3D Sketch** on the Sketch tab or the Fast Structure tab (or **Insert ▸ 3D Sketch**). The sketch opens empty with the Line tool ready; there is no plane to pick. While it is open the **3D Sketch** button stays highlighted and the first button becomes **Exit 3D Sketch**. Tools that only work in 2D sketches are greyed out. **Ctrl+Z** / **Ctrl+Y** undo and redo inside the sketch.

7.2 Drawing in space

- Click points to draw lines. A line snaps along **X, Y or Z** from the last point whenever the mouse moves along that direction on screen, in any view. A dashed line shows it and an Along X/Y/Z relation is added. Hold **Ctrl** or **Shift** to draw freely.
- Away from the axes, lines follow the **drawing plane** through the last point. **Tab** cycles XY → YZ → ZX; the plane's name shows at the cursor.
- **Ctrl**+click a plane or flat face, or click a plane in the tree, to draw on it. Points placed there get an **On Plane** relation. **Tab** or **Esc** goes back to XY / YZ / ZX.
- Points snap, in this order, to the sketch's own points, to line and arc midpoints (Midpoint relation), to a point along a line (On Line relation), to the origin and model vertices, along X/Y/Z, then to the drawing plane.
- The **Next Point** box in the Property panel takes exact offsets, for example `0, 0, 250`.
- A selected point shows its X, Y and Z; type new values to move it. A selected line shows its length, ΔX/ΔY/ΔZ and end points; an arc its radius, angle and length.

7.3 3D sketch tools

Tool	Key	How it works
Line	**L**	As above
Centerline		Construction lines that shape the sketch (for example a frame envelope) but make no curve
Point		A lone point
Circle, **Centerpoint Arc**, **3 Point Arc**, **Polygon**	**C**, **A**, **P**	Drawn on the active drawing plane through the first click. **Tab** changes the plane before or between clicks. A polygon stays regular.
Tangent Arc		Click the free end of a line, arc or spline, then where the arc ends. Keep clicking for more arcs; **Esc** ends.

Tool	Key	How it works
Spline	`N`	Click the points it runs through; double-click or `Enter` ends it, clicking the first point closes it. A Tangent relation with a line at an end makes it leave the line smoothly. Select a spline to set its **Shape**: tangent-smooth (C1) or **curvature-continuous (C2)**, whose curvature runs on smoothly through every point; and its **end weights** (how strongly the end tangents pull; more leaves the ends straighter). **Show curvature** draws curvature combs on the splines.
Sketch Fillet / Sketch Chamfer		Click a corner where two lines meet. The sharp corner stays as a point on both lines, so lengths measured to it keep their meaning.
Trim	`T`	Click the piece to remove, up to where other entities cross or touch it
Project Edges	`E`	Click model edges to bring them in, linked to the model (see below)
Dimension	`D`	Length, distance between points, angle between lines, arc radius, circle diameter. While placing a length, `Tab` cycles true length → ΔX → ΔY → ΔZ.
Construction Geometry	`Q`	Toggles the selected lines to or from construction
Delete	`Del`	Deletes the selection

Move / Copy / Rotate: drag a selected line, arc or circle to move the selection (it snaps along X, Y and Z), or type ΔX/ΔY/ΔZ and click **Move** or **Copy**, or rotate about X, Y, Z or the drawing plane's normal with **Rotate** or **Copy Rotated**. Copies keep the relations among the copied geometry. Fixed and projected geometry stays put.

7.4 Relations in 3D

Along X/Y/Z, Parallel, Perpendicular, Collinear, Equal Length, Equal Radius, Tangent, Midpoint, On Line, Parallel to XY / YZ / ZX, On XY / YZ / ZX plane, On Plane, Regular Polygon, Fix and Merge (coincident). A solver keeps everything held and reports **Fully defined** or the degrees of freedom left. A relation or dimension that conflicts is refused with a message.

7.5 Projected edges in 3D

Project Edges brings model edges into the 3D sketch: lines stay lines, circular edges become arcs or circles and other curves become splines, with shared corner points. The geometry (purple) stays linked to the model: when the part changes, it follows the edges, and lines and dimensions attached to it follow too. **Unlink from the Model** in the Property panel makes it ordinary geometry.

7.6 Curves from a 3D sketch

Each connected run of lines, arcs and splines is one curve; a T-junction splits it into separate runs. A run can be used as straight segments with an optional bend radius at the corners (pipe and duct routes) or as a smooth spline, and can be closed into a loop. **Sweep**, **Swept Surface**, **Lofted Surface**, **Curve Driven Pattern** and **Structural Member** use 3D sketches.

8 Gears

RazorCAD's **Gears** tool on the Sketch tab draws involute gear trains as closed profiles, ready to extrude.

8.1 Creating a gear train

1. Draw lines between the gear centres (centerlines work well).
2. Select the lines (or a single point for one gear) and click **Gears**. If you are not in a sketch, RazorCAD opens the selected sketch (or starts one) and asks you to click the centre lines, then press **`Enter`** or **Make Gears**.
3. Each line end point becomes a gear. Neighbouring gears mesh along the line, and teeth are turned automatically so they mesh.
4. Extrude the sketch: each gear becomes its own body.

Gear numbers are shown on the gears in the sketch (view labels only, not geometry).

8.2 The Gear Train panel

Click a gear to open it.

Setting	Meaning
Module and pressure angle	The tooth size and shape for the whole train
Teeth per gear, or ratio per mesh	Setting a ratio sets the next gear's teeth. Changing teeth or a ratio changes the centre-line lengths to suit, including your own length dimensions on those lines.
Backlash, tip/root clearance	Tolerances for prototyping and 3D printing
Bore diameter	The centre hole
Turn	Rotates the first gear
Set the line lengths to the mesh distance	Adds driving dimensions so the gears mesh exactly; each mesh shows ✓ or how far off it is

8.3 Rules for a valid train

Centres must be exactly at the mesh distance, gears must not overlap and each gear needs at least 6 teeth. Fixed line lengths get a module and teeth that fit. Edits that would break a train are refused. A broken train is drawn red with a **Fit gears to the lines** button and can't be extruded.

9 Airfoils

The **Airfoil** tool on the Sketch tab draws a wing or blade section on a line.

9.1 Drawing an airfoil

1. Select a line in a sketch and click **Airfoil** (or click **Airfoil**, then the line).
2. The line becomes the **chord**: a construction line with the leading edge at its start. The airfoil is drawn on it.
3. The airfoil follows the line. Drag its ends or dimension it (or set **Chord length** in the panel) and the airfoil scales and turns with it.
4. Extrude the sketch. The profile is one smooth closed curve that follows the exact section to within 0.002 % of the chord.

9.2 Sections

Choice	Sections
Library	28 NACA 4-digit sections (0006 to 6412), 10 NACA 5-digit sections (21012 to 25012, and the reflexed 23112), and Clark Y (11.7 %, 8, 10 and 14 %)
NACA code	Type any code, for example `4415` or `23012`
Custom	4-digit: maximum camber, its position and thickness. 5-digit: design lift coefficient, camber position, reflexed camber line and thickness. Clark Y: thickness. Decimals are allowed.

Options: sharp or blunt trailing edge, camber to the other side, and the leading edge at the other end of the line.

10 Tutorial: a Guided Loft and a Sheet Metal Tray

This tutorial builds a small duct and a tray with tools added in the 0.17 versions: the closed control-point spline, a plane placed with **Placement**, a loft that follows a guide curve, a variable fillet with a point along its edge, and edge flanges that meet corner to corner. The finished part is in **File ▸ Open Example Part (Tutorial)** (also on the start window): open it to look round, or follow the steps in a new part.

10.1 The bottom profile

1. Select the **Top Plane** and click **Sketch**.
2. Click **Control-Point Spline** on the Sketch tab and click eight control points round the origin, roughly at (50, 0), (40, 25), (0, 30), (−40, 25), (−50, 0), (−40, −25), (0, −30) and (40, −25). Click the first point again to close it: the curve runs round smoothly, near the points rather than through them.
3. Select the spline: its panel shows the **Degree** (3) and the **Closed** box. Select a control point to see its **Weight**; leave it at 1 for now. Drag a control point and the curve follows.
4. Exit the sketch.

10.2 A plane, moved and turned

1. Click **Reference Plane**, pick the **Top Plane** and set the offset to 100.
2. Under **Placement**, set **Turn its axes in the plane** to 30°: the plane's axes turn in the plane, so whatever is sketched on it turns with them.
3. Sketch a circle of radius 20 at the origin on this plane and exit the sketch.

10.3 The guide curve

1. Sketch on the **Front Plane**. With **Control-Point Spline**, click three points: the first where the bottom profile crosses the X axis (about 46.67, 0), one out to the side (about 62, 45) and the last on the circle (20, 100). Finish with a double-click or **Enter**.
2. A guide curve has to touch every profile. The first point lies on the bottom profile's curve, not on a control point: with these control points the curve crosses the axis at 140/3 = 46.6667 mm (select the point and type 46.6667 for its X in the panel).

10.4 The guided loft

1. Click **Loft**, pick the bottom sketch and then the circle's sketch as the profiles.
2. Under **Guide Curves**, pick the guide sketch. The loft's side follows the guide between the two profiles, and the profiles stay exactly as drawn. The note reads "2 profiles, 1 guide curve".

10.5 A fillet with a point along its edge

1. Click **Fillet**, set the type to **Variable size** and **Radius** to **At vertices and points along edges**, and click the loft's bottom edge where the guide starts.
2. Set the radius to 3: that is the radius at the edge's vertices.
3. Under **Points along the edges**, click **Add Point**: half way along the edge (50 %) with a radius of 8. The point is marked on the edge; the fillet swells smoothly from 3 at the vertices to 8 there.

10.6 The tray

1. Sketch an 80 × 60 rectangle on the **Top Plane**, beside the duct, and click **Base Flange** on the Sheet Metal tab with a thickness of 1.5 mm.
2. Click **Edge Flange** and pick the four top edges, with a length of 20. Under **Corners**, **Corner to corner** is the default: where two flanges meet, each runs on up to the other's inside face and ends square, the gap apart, and the bends end in a small V cutout. **Mitred** would close them on the diagonal, and **Overlap** would run one flange past the other's end.
3. Click **Flatten** to see the tray laid out, with its bend lines.

> **Tip:** change any value in the tree (the spline's degree, a weight, the plane's turn, the fillet's point) and the part rebuilds from there.

11 Solid Features

11.1 Live previews

While a feature's Property panel is open, the model is rolled back to just before that feature and the feature is shown in colour: **yellow** for material it adds and **red** (seen through the body) for material it removes. Fillets and chamfers show the material they add or remove; reference geometry being edited is drawn in orange. Click ✓ (or **Enter**) to finish.

Every value field accepts numbers or equations (see Equations in the Evaluate chapter).

11.2 Extrude and Extrude Cut

Extrudes a sketch profile into a solid, or cuts it out.

End conditions:

End condition	Meaning
Blind	A set depth
Mid Plane	The depth split equally on both sides of the sketch
Through All / Through All – Both	Through every body, in one or both directions
Up To Vertex	Click a model vertex or choose a reference point
Up To Surface	Click a flat model face or choose a plane; angled surfaces are supported and the extrusion is trimmed to the surface
Offset From Surface	As Up To Surface, at a set distance from it

Options:

- **Merge result** (boss): untick to keep the new material as a separate body even where it touches. A boss that doesn't touch existing material makes a new body anyway.
- **Thin Feature**: makes a wall of the given thickness from the profile; direction one side, other side or mid-plane. Open sketches switch it on automatically.
- **Feature Scope** (cuts): **All bodies** by default; untick it and click the bodies to cut.

11.3 Revolve and Revolve Cut

Revolves a profile about an axis: the sketch axes, any line in the sketch (such as a centerline), a reference axis, a straight model edge or a cylindrical face (click it in the view). Cuts have the same Feature Scope option as extruded cuts.

11.4 Sweep and Sweep Cut

Sweeps a profile along a path.

- **Profile**: a sketch, or **Circular** with a diameter (useful for springs).
- **Path**: a sketch chain or a helix.
- **Thin** option.

11.5 Loft and Loft Cut

Blends between two or more section profiles, in order. A third or later profile shapes the middle.

Activate **Select profiles in canvas**, then click a sketch contour or inside a closed region. Multiple regions in one sketch can be selected independently; holes belong to their enclosing region. **Select guides in canvas** switches to guide selection, including construction curves. Source sketches are temporarily shown while selecting, without changing their saved visibility.

Chain selection picks connected curves automatically. Turn it off to select individual segments from one sketch, then choose **Add selected contour** or press Enter. Escape clears an unfinished selection. Profiles and guides have separate ordered lists with move and remove controls, matching numbered highlights in the canvas. **Other sources** retains whole-sketch and supported 3D curve selection. Stored contour references follow source curve IDs through edits and renaming; missing or ambiguous boundaries report an error. Surface Loft uses the same contour selection for open or closed sections.

- A circle is split into as many equal arcs as the other profile has corners.
- Profiles with different segment counts give an error naming the sketches.
- Options: straight (ruled) sides, Thin. Without straight sides: **Through the profiles** curvature-continuous (C2) or tangent-continuous (C1), and **Smooth the surface**, which evens out its bends.
- **Guide Curves** (optional): curves the loft's outline follows between the profiles, such as a body's outline seen from the side. Each runs from the first profile to the last, through every profile, and is a selected chain of sketch curves or a supported curve source. Separate guides can come from the same sketch. One guide pulls the loft along it; two or more shape it round the outline, each where it touches the profiles. The profiles themselves are kept as drawn. Holes in the profiles, and a thin loft's inside, move with the outline, so a thin wall keeps its thickness; for a thin loft, draw the guide on the sketched line.

11.6 Hole

Hole (Features tab, **Insert** ▸ **Features** ▸ **Hole...**) makes standard holes.

Type	Sizes
Hole (clearance)	ISO 273 close, normal or loose fit, for M2 to M24
Counterbore	For socket head cap screws (ISO 4762)
Countersink	ISO 10642, 90°
Tapped hole	ISO metric or Unified (inch), drilled at the tap drill size; the thread is shown as a cosmetic thread and given in drawing callouts
Custom sizes	Your own diameters and depths

- **Blind** with a 118° drill point, or **Through All**; reversible.
- Place holes at clicked points on a flat face, or exactly at the points and circle centres of a sketch on the face.
- Holes work on sheet metal too, and a drawing's **Hole Callout** reads their size from the feature.

11.7 Helix

Pick a sketch with a circle; it sets the axis and diameter. Define the helix by **pitch and revolutions**, **pitch and height**, or **height and revolutions**. Options: start angle, clockwise, reverse. Use a helix as a sweep path for springs and coils.

11.8 Thread Cut and Thread Extrude

Click a bore (Thread Cut) or a shaft (Thread Extrude).

- The size is chosen automatically from the diameter, or choose a **metric** (ISO) or **inch** (Unified) standard size, or custom. Coarse / UNC sizes are preferred.
- Optional pitch; **left-hand** option.
- Length: the whole face, a depth, or up to a plane or face. Threads never reach past the ends of their face.
- The bore or shaft is resized to the thread size if needed (a bore to the minor diameter, a shaft to the major). A bore that would break out of the body is refused.
- Threads run all the way to the ends: grooves run out into open air, otherwise the thread is cut off flush with the end.

11.9 Cosmetic Thread

Cosmetic Thread (Features tab, **Insert** ▸ **Features** ▸ **Cosmetic Thread...**) marks a bore or shaft as threaded without modelling the thread, so it costs nothing to rebuild. Use it where the thread only needs to be shown and called out.

- Click the bore (internal thread) or the shaft (external thread). The thread starts at the end nearest the click; **Start from the other end** reverses it.
- Size, pitch, left-hand and length (whole face, depth, or up to a plane or face) as for Thread Cut. The feature's note says when the face is not the size the thread expects (a bore about the minor diameter, a shaft the major).
- In the model it shows as a thin helix on the face. Tapped holes made with the Hole feature show their threads the same way.
- On drawings it is drawn by convention: from the side, thin lines at the thread's other diameter and a line where it ends, dashed for a hidden bore; end on, a three-quarter circle. A view's **Cosmetic threads** box turns them off.
- **Hole Callout** on a bore with a cosmetic thread gives the thread, for example "M10×1.5 THRU ALL / TAP DRILL Ø8.5 THRU ALL".

11.10 Wrap (Emboss / Deboss)

Pick a sketch (outlines and/or text) and a face, flat or curved. The sketch is projected along its normal onto the face and raised (emboss) or sunk (deboss) by the depth.

11.11 Patterns and Mirror

Patterns and mirrors copy features or bodies. Any feature that changes the bodies at a place can be copied: extrudes, cuts, holes, fillets, chamfers, drafts, domes and sheet metal forms. A feature without a shape of its own (such as a fillet) is run again on the matching edges or faces of each copy.

Feature	Copies
Linear Pattern	Along one or two directions (X, Y, Z or any reference axis)
Circular Pattern	Round an axis (X, Y, Z or any reference axis)
Mirror	About a plane or flat face
Sketch Driven Pattern	At every point (or circle centre) of a sketch
Curve Driven Pattern	Along a sketch, 3D sketch or helix, spaced evenly to the end or at a set distance; moved, or turned to follow the curve

Feature	Copies
Fill Pattern	On a square or staggered grid over a flat face, kept a margin from its edges (for example a perforated panel)

What to copy. Choose the **Feature**, and add any number of **More features**: each is copied the same way. In a Linear, Circular, Sketch Driven or Curve Driven Pattern, **Clicking the model picks** either **Faces**, where each face brings the feature that made it (click a hole's wall to copy the hole), or **Bodies**, which are copied whole to every place as new bodies. Mirror takes bodies too (tick them, or click them on the model). Fill Pattern copies features only.

Feature folders. Right-click a feature ▸ **Add to New Folder…** (or **Move to** a folder already there, or **Remove from Folder**) to group features in the tree; a folder sits where its first feature is, with its features under it. Right-click a folder to rename it, delete it (its features stay), or make a **Linear** or **Circular Pattern of the Folder**. A pattern's **More features** list takes folders too: it copies whatever is in the folder each time it rebuilds, so a feature added to the folder later is copied as well.

Patterns of cuts are cut out in one operation, and patterns of added features (bosses, pins, ribs) are fused into the body in one operation, so large patterns rebuild quickly. A plate with 200 bosses builds in about 2 seconds.

A pattern or mirror of a sheet metal feature that makes a body (Base-Flange, SM-Extrude, Lofted-Bend, Transition) copies that body as it is at the pattern, with the flanges and cuts added to it so far. Each copy is sheet metal with its own flat pattern. A mirrored copy's flat pattern is the mirror image, with its bends going the other way. A mirrored lofted bend becomes a plain solid.

11.12 Fillet

Open the feature and click edges on the model. The model is rolled back to just before the feature so every edge can be picked; tick **Preview** to see the result. The radius accepts equations.

- Edges are remembered by type, direction and position, and found again after parameter changes.
- Where a fillet can't be added on top of earlier fillets (a corner where several blends meet), RazorCAD recomputes it together with the preceding fillets in one operation.
- Where two blends exactly meet (for example R2 on both edges of a 4 mm wall) the result is a full round.
- **Variable size**: a radius at the start and another at the end of each edge, or **Radius ▸ At vertices and points along edges**: the panel lists the vertices of the selected edges (the ends of each run of edges) with a radius for each; empty ones use the fillet's radius. Along each edge the radius changes from the one at its start to the one at its end.
- **Points along the edges** (with radii at the vertices): **Add Point**, then choose the edge, where along it (the share of its length from its start in %, or a distance from its start in mm) and the radius there; or **Add by Clicking** and click on the edge where the point goes. The radius runs smoothly from the edge's start through its points to its end. While the fillet is edited each point is marked on its edge, so you can see which end the % counts from; **drag a mark** along its edge to move the point (its % or mm follows, and the fillet rebuilds when you let go).
- **Setback at corners**: where three or more fillets meet, the corner is blended smoothly from this distance out, instead of the usual small corner patch. A little more than the radius works well; 0 keeps the usual corner. The fillet's note says how many corners were blended.
- **Face fillet**: pick faces instead of edges; the edges where they meet are rounded.

11.13 Chamfer

Click edges as for a fillet. Chamfer types: **equal distance**, **distance + angle** or **two distances**. **Flip direction** swaps the sides.

11.14 Shell

Click the faces to remove and set the wall thickness, inward or outward. Where a fillet or chamfer is smaller than the wall, the outside keeps it and the inside gets a sharp corner.

11.15 Draft

Pick a neutral face, then the faces to tilt by an angle. **Reverse** tilts them the other way.

11.16 Rib

An open sketch line is thickened and filled out until it meets the model, either in the sketch plane (for example a gusset across a bracket corner) or square to it.

11.17 Dome

A spherical cap or half ellipsoid on round faces, or a smooth dome filled over any other flat outline. **Reverse** presses it in.

11.18 Move Face

Push or pull flat faces along their normal, or turn a face about one of its edges. The neighbouring faces follow.

11.19 Scale

Scales every body by one factor, about the origin or about the centre of the bodies.

11.20 Long operations

If a feature takes more than a few seconds, a banner above the model says what is being worked on ("Still working on Extrude Cut1 (12 s)…") with a **Stop** button (also next to the progress bar). Stop restarts the geometry kernel: a feature you are still editing is cancelled and a finished feature is suppressed, so you can unsuppress it to try again.

12 Bodies and Multi-Body Parts

12.1 Solid bodies

A part can contain several solid bodies. A boss that doesn't touch the existing material makes a new body; untick **Merge result** to keep a touching boss separate. A cut that slices a body in two leaves two bodies.

The **Solid Bodies (n)** folder at the top of the tree lists the bodies:

- Click a body to select and highlight it.
- Double-click (or right-click ▸ **Rename**) to name it. Unnamed bodies are named after the last feature that changed them.
- Bodies are identified by the feature that created them, so names and materials stay attached when you change dimensions.
- **Folders**: right-click ▸ **Add to New Folder** or **Move to folder** to organise bodies.
- **Identical bodies** are listed once with their count (×N). Open the item to see each body. Right-click for Isolate, Hide or Show all of them. Identical means the same volume, surface area, principal moments of inertia, handedness and material (and for sheet metal, the same thickness and flat pattern).

12.2 Body Properties

Right-click a body (tree or view) ▸ **Body Properties...**. It holds the body's name, **material**, description and any number of **custom properties** (name/value pairs such as part number or finish). It also shows the body's mass, volume, area and centre of mass. For sheet metal bodies it adds the sheet data (Sheet Metal chapter).

12.3 Materials

The **Material** item in the tree sets the part material (**Tools** ▸ **Edit Material...**). A body set to **Use part material** follows it. A body given its own material keeps it when the part material changes and is drawn in that material's colour. Mass Properties adds up every body with its own density. The material list is in Appendix B.

12.4 Appearance

Right-click a face ▸ **Appearance...** or a body ▸ **Body Appearance...** to give it a colour, or **Default colour** to set it back. Face colours stay with their face when the model changes. A body's own appearance wins over its material colour and over colours imported from a STEP file.

12.5 Exploded views of a part

A part with two or more bodies can have exploded views: **Insert** ▸ **Exploded View...**, or right-click the Solid Bodies folder. Only the display moves; the model stays as it is. The steps are made as for an assembly (see Exploded views in the Assemblies chapter).

12.6 Combine and Subtract Bodies

Combine joins bodies with **Add**, **Subtract** or **Common**; the first body clicked is the main body. **Subtract Bodies** picks a cutting body and target body; **Consume cutting body** (on by default) removes the cutting

body afterwards.

12.7 Split

Cuts bodies into separate bodies with a plane, a flat face or a surface body. With a plane or face you can keep all the pieces or just the piece on one side.

12.8 Move/Copy Bodies

Moves or copies solid and surface bodies.

- **By coordinates**: ΔX/ΔY/ΔZ plus a rotation about X/Y/Z or a reference axis, through the axis or the bodies' centre. Copies repeat the step.
- **With mates**: Coincident, Distance, Parallel, Perpendicular, Angle and Concentric between an entity of the moving bodies (face, edge, vertex) and fixed geometry (another body, a plane, axis or point). **Flip alignment** turns a mate around.

12.9 Delete Body

Removes a body from the model from that point in the history. Deleting the Delete Body feature brings the body back.

13 Surfaces

The **Surfaces** tab builds surface bodies (zero-thickness faces), listed under **Surface Bodies** in the tree. Cuts and Combine only act on solid bodies; Knit, Thicken or Convert to Solid turn surfaces into solids.

13.1 Making surfaces

Feature	What it does
Extruded Surface	Sweeps the sketch's curves in a straight line; open chains are fine
Revolved Surface	Revolves the sketch's curves about an axis
Planar Surface	Fills a closed sketch (holes allowed)
Lofted Surface	A surface through two or more profiles (sketches or 3D sketches), open or closed, optionally ruled (straight between profiles). Open profiles drawn in opposite directions are lined up automatically. **Guide Curves** (rails, optional): sketches or curves the surface follows between the profiles, e.g. along its edges; each runs from the first profile to the last, through every profile. One guide pulls the surface along it; two or more shape it across, each where it touches the profiles.
Swept Surface	An open or closed sketch profile, or a circle, swept along a sketch, 3D sketch or helix
Filled Surface	A smooth patch over a hole bounded by edges of a surface or a solid, touching or optionally tangent to the faces round it. It can be knit into the surface and close a solid. A flat loop gives a flat patch.
Boundary Surface	A surface through curves in two directions. The first and last curve of each direction bound it and must meet at their ends; the curves between shape it.
Ruled Surface	Straight-sided surfaces standing on edges, either normal to the surface or along a direction tapered by an angle, on one or both sides (for example mould parting surfaces)
Offset Surface	Offsets faces of any body
Copy Surface	Copies faces of any body as surface bodies, leaving the body unchanged. **Join copies that touch into one surface body** is on by default.

13.2 Changing surfaces

Feature	What it does
Trim Surface	Cuts surfaces with a plane, a surface body or a sketch's curves (square to the sketch). Click the pieces to keep, or to remove. **Mutual** trims the tool surface too.
Extend Surface	Carries open edges straight on by a distance, following the surface's slope at the edge, and knits the extension on
Untrim Surface	Fills a surface's holes, or gives it back its natural extent (holes and outline). Pick faces to untrim only those.
Knit Surface	Sews surfaces together within a gap tolerance. When they enclose a volume, **Try to form a solid** turns them into a solid.
Thicken	Gives a surface a wall thickness (one side or both) and makes it a solid
Delete Face	Takes faces out of a solid or surface. Either leave the hole (the body becomes a surface body) or patch each hole smoothly, optionally tangent, so the solid stays solid. Good for removing fillets and bad faces from imported parts.

Feature	What it does
Replace Face	Moves flat faces of a solid onto a surface body, so the body grows or shrinks to meet it (for example a curved top). The surface must reach past the faces all round.
Flatten Surface	Unrolls faces of a surface or solid flat beside the model as a surface body (see below)
Split (with a surface)	Splits solid bodies with a surface body
Move/Copy Surfaces	As Move/Copy Bodies, for surfaces
Delete Surface	Removes a surface body

13.3 Curves and split lines

Feature	What it does
Split Line	Splits faces along a sketch's projection, or where a plane or surface crosses them. The body stays one body with its faces split, for example for a parting line, a draft or a colour.
Projected Curve	Projects a sketch along its normal onto faces, as a 3D curve
Composite Curve	Joins model edges end to end into one curve

Projected and composite curves can be used as sweep paths, lofted surface profiles, curve-driven pattern paths and boundary surface curves.

13.4 Flatten Surface

Click the faces to unroll. Faces that unroll (cylinders, cones, bent sheets) come out exact. A doubly curved face (for example a dome) can't lie flat without stretching: it is spread out keeping its edge lengths as well as possible, and the note gives the size, the area change and how much the edge lengths changed. **Relaxing passes** sets how hard it tries. A closed tube needs a seam (Split Line) to open out.

13.5 Meshes and closing surfaces

- **Convert to Solid** (also right-click a surface body): surface bodies that together enclose a volume, or a mesh, are joined (edges closer than the gap tolerance meet) and made into one solid. When they leave gaps it says how many open edges and holes there are.
- **Repair Mesh**: closes the holes of a surface body or a mesh with missing pieces (flat holes with a flat face, curved holes with a filling surface, holes in a mesh with triangles), turns triangles that face the wrong way round, and makes a solid. Option: the largest hole to close.

Surface quality can be checked with Zebra Stripes, Curvature and Draft Analysis (Evaluate and Tools chapter).

14 Reference Geometry

14.1 Reference Plane

Pick up to three references (faces, edges or vertices on the model; lines, circles, arcs or points of a sketch shown in the view; planes in the view; planes, axes or points in the tree). A sketch line counts as an edge, a sketch circle or arc as its axis, a sketch point as a vertex, and the plane follows the sketch when it changes. The plane type follows from what you pick. Click a reference again to remove it.

References	Plane made
One plane or face	Offset (distance, flip)
Two planes or faces	Mid plane: halfway between parallel faces, or the bisector of angled ones
Plane/face + edge/axis	Through the edge at an angle (Parallel 0° and Perpendicular 90° buttons)
Edge/axis (+ optional point)	Normal to the edge, at its start, middle, end or the point
Plane/face + point/vertex	Parallel, through the point
Three points or vertices	Through three points
Edge/axis + point/vertex, **Through the edge and the point** ticked	Through the edge and the point
Two edges or axes	Through both (they must meet or be parallel)
Edge/axis, position **At a distance from the start**	Normal to the edge, at that distance along it
Cylindrical face	Tangent to it, at an angle round it
Cylindrical face + plane/face	Tangent to it, parallel to the plane (either side)

Placement, for any plane: move it along its normal, turn its axes in the plane (how a sketch on it lies), or reverse its normal.

14.2 Reference Axis

Made from two planes, two reference points, a straight or circular model edge, a sketch line, or a cylindrical face (axis at its centre). Right-click an edge ▸ **Reference Axis** to start one. Axes are drawn dashed and follow the model when it changes. A reference axis can drive a revolve or a pattern.

14.3 Reference Point

Coordinates (equations allowed), a model vertex, an arc centre or an edge midpoint. Right-click a vertex ▸ **Reference Point** to start one.

15 The Feature Tree and History

15.1 Editing features

- Double-click a feature, or right-click ▸ **Edit Feature**, to open its Property panel.
- Select a feature and press **Del** (or **Edit** ▸ **Delete**) to delete it.
- **Edit** ▸ **Undo / Redo** (**Ctrl+Z** / **Ctrl+Y**) works on the whole part history.
- **Rebuild** (**Ctrl+B**, or the quick button) rebuilds the part.
- A feature that fails shows an error in the tree so you can fix or re-pick its references (see Fix References).

15.2 References that follow edits

Features that use picked edges and faces (fillets, chamfers, shells, drafts, axes…) find them again after the model changes. An edge remembers the faces on its two sides and whether it is an outside or inside corner. When a dimension moves it so far that other edges now lie nearer its old place, the right edge is still found, and an edge of another kind is not taken for it. A face that moved is found as the face facing the same way that is clearly nearest. A reference found again this way is updated, so it keeps following the model.

15.3 Fix References

Tools ▸ **Fix References…** lists every feature that failed to rebuild, what went wrong and which of its edges or faces are no longer in the model. Open it also by clicking the red error count in the status bar, or by right-clicking a failed feature. For each feature:

Button	What it does
Edit	Opens the feature (or sketch) to pick its references again
Remove missing	Keeps the references that are still found and drops the others
Suppress	Leaves the feature out for now

Fix them from the top: a feature can fail only because one above it did. The list follows every rebuild while it is open.

15.4 Rollback bar

The blue line at the bottom of the tree. Drag it up, or right-click a feature ▸ **Roll Back** / **Roll to End**. Features below the bar are suppressed, and new features are inserted above it.

15.5 Reordering features

Drag a feature up or down the tree. Its absorbed sketch moves with it. A move that would break a reference is refused with the reason.

15.6 Reference arrows

Select a feature in the tree. Blue arrows come from what it uses; purple arrows go to what uses it.

15.7 Tree symbols

Sheet metal features and bodies have their own icons. Under-defined sketches show **(-)**. Sketches absorbed by features are hidden by default.

16 Sheet Metal

The **Sheet Metal** tab holds the sheet metal features. Sheet metal bodies are listed in the **Sheet Metal Bodies** folder below Solid Bodies, with sheet metal icons.

Group	Features
Making a sheet	Base Flange, Sheet Metal Extrude, Lofted Bend, Transition / Reducer, Convert to Sheet Metal
Flanges and bends	Edge Flange, Miter Flange, Hem, Sketched Bend, Jog
Forms and details	Cross Break, Tab and Slot, Forming Tools, Gusset
Corners	Corner Relief, Closed Corner
Flat	Unbend, Bend, Flatten
Checking and output	Sheet Metal Check, Export DXF, Export All DXF, DXF Settings

16.1 Base Flange

A closed sketch (holes allowed) becomes a sheet of the given **thickness**. The **bend radius** and **K-factor** set here become the part's defaults.

16.2 Gauge tables

Base Flange, Sheet Metal Extrude and Transition / Reducer have a **Gauge** list: mild steel, steel gauges, stainless 304, and aluminium 5052 and 6061-T6. Picking a gauge sets the thickness, inside bend radius and K-factor. **Save...** keeps your own values as a gauge.

16.3 Sheet Metal Extrude

Extrudes an open sketch of lines and arcs into a sheet metal part. Arcs in the sketch are bends of their own radius; sharp corners get a bend of the inside radius set in the panel. Material goes on one side, the other side or both sides of the sketch; depth one way, reversed or mid-plane. A circle on its own is rolled into a cylinder, leaving a seam gap. Flanges, hems, Flatten and DXF export work on it.

16.4 Lofted Bend

A sheet metal part between two open profile sketches (each one chain of lines and arcs), for example a round-to-square transition, hopper or duct piece. Points are matched along both profiles by length, keeping every corner of either profile.

- **Method**: **Bent** makes flat facets folded along straight lines, each fold a bend line in the flat pattern and DXF; set the number of divisions. **Formed** makes a smooth sheet (rolled or pressed), with the set number of forming lines along the profiles.
- The flat pattern is developed at the neutral layer (K-factor) and works with Flatten, DXF export and flat pattern drawings. **Material on the other side** flips the thickness.
- A cut through a lofted bend is carried into its flat pattern, and the cut edges are square to the sheet, as a laser-cut blank formed to shape would be. This makes trimmed conical parts possible: loft the cone between two arcs, then cut it to the outline with a revolved cut.
- Edge flanges, corner reliefs and closed corners can't be added to a lofted bend; its shape comes from the profiles.

16.5 Transition / Reducer

Cones, concentric and eccentric reducers, square-, rectangle-, triangle-, pentagon- and hexagon-to-round transitions (either way up) and polygon frustums.

- Sizes, offset and rotation are set in the panel; sizes can be inside, outside or mean. A sketch line from bottom centre to top centre places the part and sets its height; change the line and the part follows. Started with no sketch, it asks for a plane and opens the Line tool.
- The part is made from a number of equal pieces, each a sheet metal body with its own flat pattern: a cone from one piece or more, a flat-sided transition from two or more, with seams at the middle of the flat sides or at the corners.
- **Formed** (rolled, with a set number of forming lines per corner or round the whole part) or **bent** (bump formed with a set number of bends).

16.6 Edge Flange

Click straight edges on the top or bottom face.

Setting	Options
Length	Measured to the outer virtual sharp, inner virtual sharp or tangent
Angle	Flange angle
Position	Material inside, material outside, bend outside, plus an offset; flip
Bend radius	Its own radius, or the default
Auto relief	Rectangular, obround or tear relief where a bend ends next to material
Corners	Flanges picked together that meet at a corner: **Corner to corner** (the default: each runs on up to the other's inside face and ends square, their inside edges the gap apart; the outside corner is left open and the bends end in a V cutout), **Mitred** (they meet on the diagonal), **Overlap** (one runs on to cover the other's end) or **Open**. Closed corners keep a gap (default 0.5 mm). For Overlap, **Swap** reverses which covers, and the Bend region is a V cutout or Closed.

16.7 Miter Flange

A flange with a profile of up to four segments along a chain of edges. Each segment has a length (to the outside of the bends) and an angle; a negative angle folds back the other way, so 90 / 90 makes a C and 90 / −90 a Z. The corners are mitred (closed, with a gap) at every level. **First bend** sets where the material sits on the edge, as for an edge flange.

16.8 Hem

Folds a straight edge back on itself. Hems meeting at a corner are mitred.

Setting	Options
Type	**Closed** (pressed flat), **Open** (with a gap), **Teardrop** (its own angle, default 225°) or **Rolled** (a curl)
Length	From the outside of the fold
Gap, inside radius, angle	As the type needs
Position	**Inside** (the fold at the edge) or **Outside** (added beyond the edge); flip direction

16.9 Sketched Bend

Draw lines on the top or bottom face of a flat part of the sheet; the sheet is bent along each one. Set the angle, the radius (or the part's), whether the bend is centred on the line or starts or ends at it, the fold direction and which side stays put. The flat pattern stays the plate it was.

16.10 Jog

One sketch line on a face makes two opposite bends that step the sheet over by a height. The height is measured face to face, outside to outside or inside to inside; the jog says when the height is too small for the bends.

16.11 Cross Break

Click flat faces to mark an X of shallow stiffening folds. It shows in Flatten, in the DXF (on the Forming marks layer, with a note) and in flat pattern drawings.

16.12 Tab and Slot

Click the edge of one sheet metal part where it sits on another, then the face of the other part. Tabs are added along the edge and matching slots, with clearance all round, are cut through the other part, so the parts locate each other for welding.

- Settings: number of tabs, tab length, tab height (empty: through the other part), margin at each end (empty: evenly spread) and clearance.
- Both flat patterns and DXFs get the tabs and slots.

16.13 Forming Tools

Forming Tools presses a form into the sheet. Place forms at clicked points, or exactly at the points and circle centres of a sketch on the face (for a louver, its lines). They are pressed toward the face they are placed on, or the other way.

Form	Settings
Dimple	Diameter, depth
Extruded (flanged) hole	Hole diameter inside the collar, collar height, bend radius
Louver	Width back from the slit, opening height, hood side; drawn as a line on the face (the slit)

The flat pattern gets a centre mark and a note for each form, an extruded hole's pre-hole (the collar laid flat) and a louver's slit as a cut. Forms stay with the part through later sheet metal features and are left off, rather than breaking the part, if one can't be made.

16.14 Gusset

Click a bend (its round face) to press a stiffening dart across it at that point. Set the size of each leg from the inside corner and the width across the bend; tick **Pressed down** to press it the other way. The flat pattern marks it. (For gusset plates between structural members, see the Fast Structure chapter.)

16.15 Corner Relief

Adds a rectangular, circular or tear relief at every corner where two bends meet.

16.16 Closed Corner

Closes the corners between 90° flanges: one flange covers the other's end, with a gap.

- **Corner type**: Overlap, Underlap, Butt (square ends: each flange runs on up to the other's inside face, the gap between their inside edges, the bends in a V cutout) or Mitre (the gap across the mitre, bends included).
- **Which corners**: click a face of a flange next to a corner and the matching flange is found automatically; the clicked flange is the one that overlaps or tucks under. With no corners picked, every corner of the body is closed.
- **Swap** reverses which flange covers.
- **Bend region**: **V cutout** (default) runs each bend into the corner as it would form from the flat, leaving a small teardrop-shaped opening with a relief at the corner point. **Closed** keeps the bends meeting on the diagonal.
- The flat pattern matches the folded part at closed corners, including each bend's run-on, the relief and the corner round.

16.17 Unbend and Bend

Unbend keeps the picked face in place and flattens the rest. Features after it (such as cuts across bends) are made in the flat. **Bend** folds it back to where it was. Both appear in the tree.

16.18 Cuts and other features on sheet metal

Cuts on sheet metal (extruded cut and so on) become holes in the flat pattern, so the flat pattern always matches. Holes (the Hole feature) work on sheet metal too. Other features that change a sheet metal body are allowed, but the flat pattern can't follow them; this is shown in Body Properties and the DXF preview.

16.19 Flatten

Click **Flatten** on the tab, or right-click the body ▸ **View Flat Pattern**. The flat pattern is shown on its own; **Esc** or Flatten again restores the view as it was. While it is shown, **Export DXF…** on the flat pattern banner (or right-click the view) exports it straight away.

16.20 Convert to Sheet Metal

Turns an ordinary body into sheet metal. Pick a flat face of a thin-walled body (for example a STEP export of a sheet metal part, or a shelled box), or of a knitted surface of flat faces (enter the thickness).

- RazorCAD follows that side of the sheet across every smooth edge, through flat faces and cylindrical bend faces, so the whole body is found. Each bend keeps its own radius and angle.
- Bends that run straight into each other with no flat between (rolled shapes such as a fan scroll) are joined automatically. Cut-outs in bends are kept and holes stay true circles in the DXF.
- Sharp-cornered bodies (shelled boxes) get bends of the chosen radius at every edge between two flat faces.
- A flange whose ends run right up against the material beside it, with no relief (a flange off a cross bar between the sides of a window, or off the edges of a slot), is ripped there: the flat pattern (and its DXF) has a cut line along each flange end, across the bend and on to the flange's edge, on the cut-outs layer,

as the part is cut and bent.

- The panel shows what was found in the body, for example "thickness 3 mm · bend radii R300, R227, R13 (inside, 3 bends)" or "4 sharp edges".
- **Use the body's thickness** and **Use the body's bend radii** are on by default. Untick either to set your own value (pre-filled with the detected one).
- A body curved other than in plain bends (a square-to-round transition or a reducer from another program, a cone) is **unrolled**: laid out flat at the neutral layer, triangle by triangle, so its flat pattern keeps every length; a ring is cut open at a seam. For a cone, click its curved face. A closed tube (bends all the way round) is unrolled the same way, cut open at a seam. A face curved both ways (a dished end) can't be laid flat and is refused. Cuts in such a sheet are unrolled with it (the hole is in the flat pattern); flanges, hems and corners can't be added (as on a lofted bend).
- A body that RazorCAD folded itself (for example its STEP export) gets its closed corners back as RazorCAD made them: the corner type (V cutout, closed mitre or butt), which flange covers which and the gap are worked out from the body, and the relief and curved V lines are made again exactly. Other corners are traced from the body as they are.
- After converting, the sheet's volume is compared with the body's. The feature note warns when they differ by more than 0.5 % (for example a nut or motor part that isn't sheet metal).
- A **curved surface** that is curved one way only (a cylinder, or a profile swept straight) is converted into a rolled sheet: its section is followed by smoothly joined arcs, each a bend of its own radius. **Arc fit tolerance** (default 0.05 mm) sets how closely it follows the surface. **Thickness** goes behind the surface, in front of it, or both sides.
- **Trim where the sheet would run into itself** (on by default) trims a rolled sheet back where its two ends would meet, leaving a small clearance.

16.21 Etch Lines

Sheet Metal ▸ Etch Lines: pick a sketch drawn on the top or bottom face of a flat part of the sheet. Its lines, arcs, circles, splines and text are marked in the flat pattern, for etching, scribing or marking part numbers and bend marks. They go on the DXF's **ETCH** layer (DXF Settings can leave them out) and show in flat-pattern drawing views (View Properties ▸ Etch lines), clipped to the face they are on. The folded part is not changed; the etch lines show on the model as thin lines.

16.22 Sheet Metal Check

Sheet Metal Check lists every bend of the sheet metal body: direction, angle, inside radius, length and the straight flange on each side. It warns about flanges shorter than 3 × thickness past their bend, and holes closer than 2 × thickness + radius to a bend.

16.23 Sheet metal Body Properties

Body Properties for a sheet metal body shows thickness, bend radius and K-factor, number of bends, overall flat size, flat area, mass and **quantity**, plus:

- **Cut length**: the total length of the flat outline plus every hole and cut-out, and the number of **pierces** (closed contours), for laser-cutting estimates. Also shown in the DXF part information and under flat pattern drawing views.
- **Flat pattern seen from**: top face or bottom face. The bottom face mirrors the pattern and swaps UP / DOWN bend lines and notes. Flatten, DXF export and drawing views all follow it.

16.24 Exporting flat patterns as DXF

- Right-click a sheet metal body (tree or view) ▸ **Export Flat Pattern as DXF**, or **Export DXF** on the tab.
- **Export All DXF**: choose a target folder; one file per body, named after the body. Identical bodies give one file with the quantity multiplied by the count.
- Each file is shown in a **preview window** with its layer colours and line types, which can be changed there. Buttons: **Export**, **Skip This One** and **Abort Export**.
- In the preview, zoom with the wheel, pan by dragging and double-click or **Fit** to see it all. Click lines to select them (**`Ctrl`** or **`Shift`** adds, **`Shift`**+drag for a box, **`Ctrl+A`** for all), then **Delete** them, give them their own **Line type**, or move them to another **Layer** (for example make a line an etch line). **Undo** and **Restore All** put them back. These edits apply to that one export.
- Options: bend lines, bend notes, bend region (hidden) lines, etch lines and part information.

16.25 DXF Settings

DXF Settings on the Sheet Metal tab sets the defaults for every export: layer mapping (colours and line types) and options. Defaults: **up bends red**, **down bends blue**, **etch lines yellow dashed**. **Reset to Defaults** restores them.

17 Fast Structure

The **Fast Structure** tab builds welded frames (weldments) from standard steel profiles: Structural Member, Trim/Extend, End Cap, Gusset, Weld Bead and Cut List. It also has a **3D Sketch** button, since frames are often laid out in 3D.

17.1 Structural Member

Pick a profile and a sketch or 3D sketch: every line and arc of it becomes a member, each its own body named after its profile. Add more sketches to the **Path** list for a frame in 3D, for example the top of a table and its legs; the joints between them are treated too. Arcs, and the bends of a 3D sketch with a bend radius, become bent members.

Profile	Types
Hollow sections	Square (SHS), rectangular (RHS), circular (CHS / pipe)
Angles	Equal and unequal angle
Channels and beams	Channel (PFC / UPN); I-beam (UB, UC, IPE, HEA)
Bars	Flat bar, round bar

Sizes come from AS/NZS or EN/ISO tables, or enter your own dimensions.

- **Corners** where two members meet end to end: **Mitre**, **Butt** (first or second member trimmed) or **None** (members meet at the sketch points). **Trimmed ends**: square cut on the face, or coped to the other member's outside.
- A member ending on the middle of another (a T-joint), or under a corner (a table leg), is trimmed to it, square on its face. Pipes and round bars are always coped (fish-mouthed).
- **Alignment**: which point of the profile the sketch line runs through (centre, corners or edges), a profile rotation, and mirror.

17.2 Trim/Extend

Click the members to trim on the model, then the boundary: a plane or another body. Each member is trimmed (or, with **Extend members that stop short of it**, extended) at its end nearer the boundary, either cut **square** on the boundary's face or **coped** to the boundary body.

17.3 End Cap

Click the open end faces of tubes or pipes. A plate of the set thickness is added **on the end** (outside) or **in the end** (flush).

17.4 Gusset

Click two flat faces that meet at a corner, one on each member. A triangular plate fills the corner. Set the two leg lengths, the thickness, a **corner chamfer** for weld clearance, and where the plate sits along the corner (centred or to one side, plus an offset).

End caps and gussets are bodies of their own, named by size for the cut list.

17.5 Weld Bead

Set the weld size and click the bodies to weld (none: every weldment member). A bead runs along every line where two of them touch; each joint is its own bead body.

17.6 Cut List

Cut List lists identical members together, with their profile, length, end angles, quantity, total length and mass (from the bodies' materials), then plates and welds (with the total weld length). It also gives the total length of each profile. **Export CSV…** saves it for a spreadsheet. A drawing can show it as a **Cut List Table** (Drawings chapter).

18 Configurations

A configuration is a variant of a part or assembly: other values for the global variables and other features suppressed in a part, other part configurations and components shown in an assembly.

18.1 The Configurations tab

The **Configurations** tab sits next to the Feature tree and the Property panel at the top of the left panel. It lists **Default** and every configuration, the one shown ticked, each with a summary of what it changes.

- **Double-click** a configuration to show it. The tree shows its name next to the part.
- **+ Add Configuration** makes a new one starting from the one shown.
- Right-click for **Show Configuration**, **Rename**, **Copy Configuration**, **Properties (Design Table)** and **Delete**.

18.2 What a part configuration changes

- **Variable values**: each configuration can give the global variables (Tools ▸ Equations) other values.
- **Suppressed features**: while a configuration is shown, **Suppress / Unsuppress** in the tree changes that configuration only. The tree greys out what it suppresses.

18.3 Design table

Design Table… in the Configurations tab (or right-click ▸ **Properties (Design Table)**, or **Configurations** on the Evaluate tab) edits all the configurations in one table. The table can be copied to and pasted from a spreadsheet as CSV.

18.4 Configurations in assemblies

Assemblies have the same tab. While an assembly configuration is shown, these change that configuration only: a component's part configuration, **Hide / Show**, **Suppress** (a suppressed component is left out, with its mates) and a mate's Suppress or value. See the Assemblies chapter for how components use part configurations.

19 Assemblies

An assembly places parts and other assemblies as **components** and holds them together with **mates**. Assemblies are saved as **.rasm** files and open in a tab of their own.

19.1 Starting an assembly

File ▸ New Assembly, or **New Assembly** in the start window. Every assembly has the standard **Front, Top and Right Planes** and the **Origin** at the top of its tree. They show in the view as a part's do (the eye in the tree, **View ▸ Show Planes**), and mates can use them; they stay where they are.

The **Assembly** tab of the ribbon holds Insert Components, Standard Parts, Equations, Assembly Hole, Assembly Cut, Mate, Fix, Float, Hide Component, Suppress, Open Part, Exploded View, Explode / Collapse, Motion Study, Bill of Materials, Interference Check, Collision Detection, Speed Mode and Zoom to Fit.

19.2 Inserting components

Insert Components lists the parts and assemblies open in other tabs, or **Browse for a Part or Assembly...** takes a .rcad or .rasm file.

- The first component is **fixed** at the origin; the others are placed beside what is there.
- If the part has configurations, you choose which one to use. Right-click a component later to switch it to another configuration. The same part can be in the assembly several times in different configurations.
- The assembly keeps a copy of each part, refreshed from its tab or file whenever you come back to the assembly, so edit a part and the assembly follows.
- Several instances of one part share it: it is built once and drawn once.

19.3 Standard parts

Standard Parts (Assembly tab, or **Insert ▸ Standard Parts...**) adds parts made to size from their standards:

- hex bolts (ISO 4017) and socket head cap screws (ISO 4762), M3–M24, in the standard lengths; hex nuts (ISO 4032) and washers (ISO 7089);
- inch hex bolts (ASME B18.2.1), socket head cap screws (ASME B18.3), hex nuts (ASME B18.2.2) and SAE flat washers, 1/4" to 1", with UNC threads and inch lengths;
- socket set screws (ISO 4026), dowel pins (ISO 8734), round head rivets (ISO 1051), circlips for shafts and bores (DIN 471 / 472), parallel keys (DIN 6885 A) and 6000 / 6200 series ball bearings.

Each is an ordinary part with its threads as cosmetic threads, so it builds fast. Choose its material: steel, stainless, brass or aluminium. The same type, size, length and material is one part however many times it is used, so the bill of materials counts them.

Select a hole first (its round face or edge) and the size is picked to fit it (a clearance or tapped hole for bolts, the bore for a bearing, the shaft for a key), the length to suit the hole, and the part goes into the hole at the end facing you, mated to it (Concentric, plus Coincident on the face round the hole). For a bolt or screw:

- **Washer under the head**, and **washer and nut on the far side**: the whole set is mated, and the length is picked for it (a 10 mm plate: M8 × 25).
- **All matching holes**: the same part or set goes into every hole of the same size parallel to the selected one, in one go.

A hole that ends on a curved face (a cross hole in a round bar) gets a seat plane of its own, which follows the hole when the part changes.

19.4 Mates

Click **Mate** (`M`), then two faces, edges or vertices on different components (or a standard plane), choose the type and click ✓. The panel stays open for the next mate; `Esc` closes it.

Mate	Holds
Coincident	Faces, edges or points together
Concentric	Axes in line
Parallel / **Perpendicular**	Directions
Tangent	A face touching a round face
Distance / **Angle**	At a set value
Lock	One component fixed to another
Gear	Two gears turning together: pick their cylinders (pitch circles)
Rack Pinion	A pinion turning as a rack slides: pick the pinion's cylinder and a straight edge or the flat face of the rack

- Flat faces count as planes; cylinders, cones and circular edges as axes; spheres and vertices as points.
- Each mate is shown applied while you choose. **Flip** swaps Aligned / Anti-Aligned (or the side for Distance and Tangent). When the alignment chosen from how the faces sit can't be reached, the other one is used.
- A mate that conflicts with the others is refused with a message.
- A mate keeps its faces and edges by their geometry, not only by their number in the part. When a part gets a new feature or a dimension moves a face, the mate stays on the same face. A mate whose face or edge is gone gets a red **!** in the tree ("1 mate lost a face"). **Tools ▸ Fix Mates...** lists them with Edit, Suppress and Delete.

19.4.1 Gear and rack-pinion mates

These relate one component's motion to another's, from where they are when the mate is made, so set the teeth in mesh first. Hold each gear on its axle with the usual mates (Concentric and Coincident); the gear mate then takes one more degree of freedom.

- **Gear**: turn one gear and the other turns the other way, in the ratio of their radii. **Ratio** is how many turns entity 2 makes per turn of entity 1; change it to the teeth ratio if the cylinders are not the pitch circles. **Reverse the direction** is for an internal gear, where both turn the same way. The tree shows it as for example "Gear1 1:2".
- **Rack Pinion**: turning the pinion slides the rack along the edge (or face) picked, and sliding the rack turns the pinion. **Rack travel per pinion turn** starts as the pinion's circumference (π × diameter). **Reverse** changes the direction.
- They follow turns of any size made step by step, as when you drag a gear. One jump of more than half a turn can't be told from a turn the other way.

19.5 Moving components

Left-drag a component to move it, `Alt`+drag to turn it. It moves only as its mates allow. The view turns, pans and zooms as in a part (see Navigating the 3D View).

Selecting works as in a part and follows the **selection filter**: with no filter a click picks the vertex, edge, face or plane under the cursor; with the Bodies filter it picks whole components. **Ctrl**+click adds or takes away. Right-click a face, edge or vertex for **Mate...** and the component's commands; whatever is selected goes into the mate. Dragging a component moves it, whatever is selected.

19.6 Collision detection

Collision Detection on the Assembly tab (or **Tools ▸ Collision Detection Off / Show Collisions While Dragging / Stop at Collisions While Dragging**) checks for parts running into each other as you drag.

- **Show**: the parts that collide turn red while you drag, and the status bar names them.
- **Stop**: the dragged component (and what its mates carry along) stops where it meets the other part, right against it.
- Faces that only touch (mated faces) are not collisions, nor is a shaft in a hole of its size, nor a screw in a nut or tapped hole (threads are cosmetic, so the screw is its full diameter in a bore of about its minor diameter). Parts that already overlap when the drag starts are left out.
- It works from the parts' display meshes, so it keeps up with the mouse. **Interference Check** gives the exact overlap volumes.

19.7 The assembly tree

- Each component shows **(f)** when fixed or **(-)** while still free to move, its configuration, and an eye to hide or show it.
- The **Mates** folder lists the mates; right-click one for **Edit**, **Flip**, **Suppress** or **Delete**.
- Right-click a component for **Mate...**, **Open Part** (or double-click it), **Fix / Float**, **Hide / Show**, **Suppress / Unsuppress**, **Insert Another Instance**, **Rename** and **Delete**.
- Undo and redo work in the assembly.

19.8 Sub-assemblies

An assembly can hold other assemblies as components. **Insert Components ▸ Browse for a Part or Assembly...** takes a .rasm file, and STEP assemblies keep their sub-assemblies when they open as an assembly. An assembly can't go inside itself.

- A sub-assembly is kept whole, with its own parts, placements and configurations, and moves, hides, suppresses and explodes as one. Clicking any of its parts picks it.
- Mates can use the faces, edges and vertices of the parts inside it.
- In the tree, ▶ opens a sub-assembly to show its components. Double-click one, or right-click the sub-assembly ▸ **Open Sub-assembly**, to change it in its own tab; the changes come back to the assembly.

19.9 Equations shared with the parts

Assembly ▸ Equations... (also on the Assembly tab) holds the assembly's own variables, for example `base = 6` and `thickness = 2*base`. A variable that **drives the parts** sets the variable of the same name in every part that has one, through the sub-assemblies, so related parts are sized together from the top.

- The table shows each variable's value, the parts it drives and a **Drives the parts** check box (off for a variable used only to work out others).
- The values go into the assembly's copies of the parts, so the assembly, its drawings, the BOM and exports use them. They are applied again when a part is read again from its file.

- **Update Open Parts** writes them into the parts open in tabs too, to be saved there.

19.10 Assembly holes and cuts

Assembly Hole and **Assembly Cut** (Assembly tab, or the Insert menu) make holes and cuts in the assembly, through every component they pass.

1. Click points on a flat face of a component. More points on the same face make more holes; clicking another face starts again.
2. Set the hole: simple, counterbore, countersink or tapped, a standard size (ISO 273 close, normal or loose fit) or a custom one. The first component gets the hole as chosen, the ones behind it a plain hole of the drill size. **Tap the last component** makes the last one tapped for the size. A cut is a rectangle: width, length and angle.
3. Choose **Through all** or a depth. **Components cut** lists the components it passes through; untick one to leave it out.
4. **Fasteners**: hex bolts or socket head cap screws put into each hole as it is made, with washers and a nut on the far side if wanted, as long as the stack they hold (to a standard length) and mated in the hole. Into a tapped last component, a screw goes about one diameter into the thread, without a nut.

The parts' own files are not changed: each component cut gets the feature in its copy of the part, so the assembly's drawings (hole callouts too), BOM and exports have the holes. The holes stay with the component they were clicked on: move a component and its holes are worked out again. The tree's **Assembly Features** folder lists them; right-click one to edit, suppress, rename or delete it. Fasteners put in a hole are kept when the hole is deleted.

19.11 Exploded views

Exploded View on the ribbon (or **Insert ▸ Exploded View...**) spreads components apart for display; the model and its mates stay put.

1. Click components to pick them (click again to drop one).
2. Pick a direction: ±X, ±Y, ±Z, or along a face's normal.
3. Drag the picked items along the direction, or type the distance, then click **Add Step**. **Spread Out** spaces the picked items out along the direction, one step each.
4. Click a step to change it, ✕ to delete it. **Explode lines** (dashed, from each item's place to where it is shown) can be switched off.

The tree's **Exploded Views** folder lists them. Double-click one to explode or collapse it (animated); right-click for Explode / Collapse, Animate, Edit, Rename and Delete. The **Explode / Collapse** button on the ribbon does the same for the last one. Dragging a component, adding a mate or editing collapses the view first. Exploded views are saved with the file.

19.12 Motion studies

Motion Study (Assembly tab) shows how an assembly moves. Choose a driver:

- **turning a component** about the axis of one of its mates (360°, for example);
- **sliding a component** along one of its mates' axes or faces;
- **changing a Distance or Angle mate's value** from where it is to a new one.

The motion is worked out step by step and the mates carry the other components along, gear and rack-pinion mates included. **Play / Stop** (**Space**), back to the start, a slider to go through the steps, the number of steps, the duration and **Loop**. Where the mates can't follow, the panel says at which step.

Detect collisions (on for new studies) checks every step: parts that collide show in red as the motion plays, and the panel names the first collision and its step. **Stop at the first collision** ends the motion at the step before it.

✓ keeps the study in the assembly's **Motion Studies** folder: double-click one to play it; right-click to edit, rename or delete it. Closing the panel puts the assembly back as it was: a motion study never moves the assembly itself.

19.13 Interference Check

Interference Check (Assembly tab, or **Tools ▸ Interference Check...**) finds where components overlap. Each overlap shows in red and is listed with its two components (inside sub-assemblies as "Sub-assembly ▸ Part") and its volume. Faces that only touch, such as mated faces, are not counted, and nor are the bodies of one multi-body part against each other. An exploded assembly is collapsed first, so the check is of where the mates put the parts.

19.14 Bill of Materials

Bill of Materials lists the parts with their quantities and materials: one row per part and configuration used, with suppressed components left out. It is indented: a sub-assembly's parts are listed under it (1.1, 1.2...), with the quantities in one of it. **Copy as CSV** or **Save CSV...** takes it to a spreadsheet.

- **Columns**: click a column heading to change what it shows (an item number, quantity, part, material, file, configuration, any custom property, mass, cost, or values typed in), insert a column left or right, move, rename or remove it. Typed values are edited right in the table. The columns are kept with the assembly and are part of undo; **Default Columns** goes back to the usual ones.
- **Mass and cost**: **Mass** and **Total mass** come from each part's material and volume; **Cost** and **Total cost** from a part's **Cost** property (for example 12.50, $3 or R12,50). A **TOTAL** row adds up the quantity, mass and cost; a sub-assembly adds up its parts.

19.15 STEP assemblies

Opening a STEP file that holds an assembly asks whether to open it **as an assembly** or **as one part** (see Importing in the Working with Files chapter). As an assembly, each part of the file becomes a part, each sub-assembly a sub-assembly, and each component is placed, fixed, where the file places it, with the names and colours from the file.

File ▸ Export ▸ STEP... in an assembly saves the whole assembly as one STEP file with its structure: each part once, in the configuration used, every component placed where it is and named after it, sub-assemblies kept as assemblies, and the parts' colours. Suppressed components are left out.

19.16 Saving parts as separate files

When an assembly holds parts or sub-assemblies that are only inside it (as a STEP assembly does when it opens), Save asks how to save them:

- **Save Parts as Separate Files** saves each part as a .rcad file and each sub-assembly as a .rasm file in the assembly's folder, named after them. The assembly (and each sub-assembly) then uses those files, so each part can be opened and changed on its own and the change shows in the assembly. A part used in several places is one file. If files of those names are already there, you are asked before they are replaced.
- **Save as One File** keeps everything inside the assembly file. You are not asked again, except on Save As.

19.17 Big assemblies

Each part an assembly builds is kept in the model cache (`%LOCALAPPDATA%\RazorCAD\modelcache`). Opening the assembly again shows unchanged parts straight from there, and the kernel only builds parts that changed, so a large layout reopens in seconds. Parts are built side by side in several geometry kernels at once, as many as the PC's processor threads and memory allow, and each shows as soon as it is built. Each part is sent to the graphics card once and placed at every component that uses it, so moving, hiding or exploding components is instant.

Speed Mode (Assembly tab, or **View ▸ Speed Mode**) is for very large assemblies: the parts are shown from simplified display meshes, with far fewer triangles to draw and keep in memory. The faces and edges stay the same, so mates, measuring, picking and collision detection work as before. A component you select is loaded in full; turning speed mode off shows everything in full again. It is saved with the assembly, and a large assembly suggests it in the status bar. Drawings, exports and Interference Check always use the exact geometry.

20 Drawings

RazorCAD makes 2D engineering drawings of parts and assemblies, saved as **.rdrw** files and opened in their own tab.

20.1 Starting a drawing

- **Start window ▸ New Drawing**, or **File ▸ New Drawing**, opens the set-up dialog (below) and then an empty sheet.
- **File ▸ Make Drawing from Part** (in a part), or **Make Drawing from Assembly** (in an assembly): after the set-up dialog, places the standard three views at a scale that fits, clear of the title block.
- A drawing can show assemblies as well as parts: every component is drawn where it sits, through its sub-assemblies, in the configurations shown; suppressed and hidden components are left out. Big assemblies (more than about 200 solids) are drawn fast from the parts' display meshes: lines, circles and arcs as exact as the 3D view's, and where an edge turns hidden to about two thousandths of the view's size. A site layout of thousands of solids then takes seconds a view instead of many minutes. In a view's properties, **Hidden lines** chooses Automatic, Exact or Fast; section and flat-pattern views are always exact.

Drawings are opened, saved and listed in the recent files like parts.

20.2 The sheet and its template

The default template is A3 with an ISO 5457 frame (zones and centring marks) and an ISO 7200-style title block: title, drawing number, material, scale, size, units, projection symbol, drawn / checked / approved, date, mass, company, revision, sheet n of m and general tolerances. Sheet sizes A0 to A4, landscape or portrait.

20.3 Drawing templates

A **drawing template** (.rdrt file) keeps a drawing's set-up: its sheets (size, orientation, scale, projection), the drawing settings (text height, decimals…), the title block's standing entries (company, drawn / checked / approved by, finish, tolerances, revision) and notes placed on the sheet. Views, parts and part-specific entries (title, drawing number, material, mass, date) are not kept.

- **File ▸ Save as Template…** in a drawing saves one, by default to `Documents\RazorCAD\Templates`. Opening a .rdrt file edits the template in its own tab.
- **The New Drawing dialog** lists your templates (from the Templates folder, or **Browse…** for one anywhere) and the standard ones: A4 portrait and landscape, A3, A2, A1 and A0 landscape, and A3 and A4 in third angle projection. Set the drawing name, title, drawing number, drawn by and company, and the first sheet's size, orientation, scale and projection. Tick **Use this template as my default** to have it chosen first next time. Double-click a template to create the drawing at once.
- **Change Template…** (File menu, Sheet tab, or right-click the drawing in the tree) switches an existing drawing to another template. Views, dimensions and annotations stay; company, tolerance and finish come from the new template, and the old template's notes are replaced. Undo goes back.
- **Company sheet formats**: a template can carry its own border, title block and logo in place of the standard ISO one, used on sheets of its size and orientation. Its text shows the drawing's properties, and can be set in a font installed on the PC; PDF exports embed the font. Drawing Properties lists the title block's own fields.

Changing the projection (Change Template or Sheet Properties) lays the views out again for the new projection, so a top view stays a top view.

20.4 Working on the sheet

Action	How
Zoom	Mouse wheel
Pan	Middle or right drag, or left drag on empty paper
Fit the sheet	**F**
Move views and annotations	Drag them
Edit	Double-click a view for its properties, a dimension or note to edit it
Menus	Right-click
Delete	**Del**
Undo / Redo	**Ctrl+Z** / **Ctrl+Y**

20.5 View Layout tab

Command	What it does
Model View	Pick an open part or assembly, or browse for its file (.rcad or .rasm), pick the orientation (front, back, top, bottom, left, right, isometric, dimetric, trimetric or flat pattern) and click on the sheet. Then move around it to place projected views.
Standard Views	Three views laid out for first- or third-angle projection
Projected View	A view aligned with its parent
Flat Pattern	A sheet metal body unfolded (see below)
Section View	Horizontal or vertical cutting line, hatched cut faces, A-A labels and arrows, flip
Detail View	A circle with a letter, 2:1 by default
Auxiliary View	Looks square at an inclined edge, so it shows its true shape
Break	Leaves out the middle of a long part; dimensions across the break keep the true length
Crop View	Shows only the area you draw round
Update Views	Re-reads the parts and redraws the views

A broken or cropped view can be put back to whole from its right-click menu. Section views hatch each body or component with its own angle and spacing.

Views are hidden-line projections computed by the geometry kernel.

20.6 View properties

Click a view to open its panel:

- Orientation, changeable after placing (also to and from Flat Pattern; projected and section views made from it are removed when it becomes a flat pattern, and **Ctrl+Z** brings them back).
- Display style: hidden lines removed, hidden lines visible, or wireframe; tangent edges and cosmetic threads on or off.

- **Exploded** (a view of an assembly that has exploded views): shows the view exploded as one of them. The components are where that exploded view moves them, the view keeps its place on the sheet, and its projected, section, auxiliary and detail views follow. Balloons on it pick the moved parts.
- Sheet scale or a custom scale; labels.
- **Rotate View**: −90°, +90°, 180° and 0° buttons and an angle box (degrees, counter-clockwise). Section lines, detail circles and annotations turn with the view.

Aligned views slide only along their alignment. Deleting a view deletes the views made from it.

20.7 Flat pattern views

A flat pattern view shows a sheet metal body unfolded with its outline and holes, bend lines (chain lines) with notes (UP / DOWN, angle, radius), optional bend region lines, and its flat size, thickness, number of bends and cut length underneath. It can be dimensioned (bend lines too) and exported to PDF. If the part has several sheet metal bodies, pick the body in the view properties. Instead of notes, the view can show a **bend table**: the bend lines numbered B1, B2… and a table of direction, angle and inside radius under the view. Forms, cross breaks and tabs and slots show as in the DXF.

20.8 Annotation tab

Command	How
Dimension	Click a line for its length, a circle for its diameter (an arc: radius), two points, lines or circles for the distance between them (two lines at an angle: the angle), then click where the text goes. Horizontal, vertical or aligned depends on where you place it. Prefix, suffix, tolerance and override text can be set.
Auto Dimension	Dimensions the selected views, or every view on the sheet (see below)
Check Drawing	Lists what the drawing still lacks (see below)
Note	Click on the sheet; click an edge first to add a leader
Baseline Dimension	Click the base edge or point, then each point or edge to dimension from it; the dimensions stack one above the other
Ordinate Dimension	Click the origin, then where the values line up, then the points to dimension
Chamfer Dimension	Click the chamfer edge and an edge next to it, then place the text ("3 × 45°")
Hole Callout	Click a hole. The callout gives its size and depth from the Hole feature (counterbore, countersink, tapped thread and tap drill) or its cosmetic thread, and how many of the same holes the view shows, for example "4× Ø6.6 THRU ALL / CBORE Ø11 DEEP 6.5".
Datum Feature	A datum letter in a box, with a triangle on the feature
Geometric Tolerance	A feature control frame: one of the 14 characteristic symbols, tolerance with Ø zone and material condition, and up to three datums
Surface Finish	A surface finish symbol with its roughness
Weld Symbol	Fillet, square, V, bevel or plug weld on a reference line with an arrow to the joint; arrow, other or both sides; all-around, field weld and tail
Center Mark	Click circles or arcs
Centerline	Click two lines (or two points); the centerline runs between them
Revision Table	Rows edited in one dialog; the latest revision goes into the title block
Cut List Table	The cut list of the part in the selected view (see the Fast Structure chapter); it updates when the part changes

Command	How
Balloon	Click a part in a view, then where the balloon goes. The number is that part's item in the bill of materials, found from the part under the click (in a sub-assembly, the sub-assembly's item). Keep clicking for more; **Esc** ends. Where the part can't be told, it asks for the number. Right-click a balloon ▸ **Item Number...** to change it.
BOM Table	The bill of materials of the drawing's assembly: ITEM, QTY, PART and MATERIAL, at the top right of the sheet. Drag it anywhere; right-click it to show the sub-assemblies' parts (indented). It follows the assembly. Right-click a column to change what it shows (any field, custom property, mass, cost or typed values), insert, move, rename or remove it; double-click a typed value to edit it. **Columns...** (right-click the table, or double-click it) has everything in one dialog. With mass or cost columns a TOTAL row is added.

Datum features, geometric tolerances, surface finish and weld symbols can each have a leader. Right-click one ▸ **Edit...** to change it.

20.8.1 Auto Dimension

Annotation ▸ **Auto Dimension** (also **Insert** ▸ **Annotations**) adds the dimensions the selected views need, or every view on the sheet's: the overall sizes, outermost; hole diameters, one per size ("4× Ø9"); arc radii; and hole positions. Each size is given once in the drawing, and nothing is added that a view's own dimensions already give. Only views looking along the part's axes are dimensioned.

It asks how, and keeps your choices for next time:

- **Positions**: baseline (each from the view's edge), chain (edge to hole to hole on one row) or ordinate (values from the view's bottom left corner).
- **Tolerance**, for example ±0.1, added to the new lengths and diameters.
- **Spread labels that would overlap**.
- **Add**: which kinds (overall sizes, hole diameters, hole positions, arc radii).

Everything it adds is one undo step; drag the dimensions to tidy them up.

20.8.2 Check Drawing

Annotation ▸ **Check Drawing** (or **Tools** ▸ **Check Drawing...**) lists what the drawing still lacks before it goes out, most important first:

- **Title block**: fields left empty. Title, drawing number, drawn by, date, revision and material are to fix; checked and approved are noted, to be filled in at sign-off.
- **Dimensions per view**: part views with no dimensions (a view whose sizes all show in other views is only noted), crowded views, annotations whose view was deleted and dimensions that lost what they measured.
- **Undimensioned features**: overall sizes, hole diameters, radii and hole positions that no dimension gives. A size given in one view is not asked for again in the part's other views, a hole callout gives a hole's diameter, and hole positions count in baseline, chain or ordinate style.

Click an item to show its view or annotation. **Add Missing Dimensions** puts in what Auto Dimension would; **Title Block...** opens the drawing's properties.

20.8.3 DXF drawings on the sheet

Insert ▸ **DXF Drawing...** places a DXF file's lines, circles, arcs, polylines, ellipses, splines and texts on the sheet as one item, in the middle of the frame at full size or scaled down to a standard scale that fits. Drag it, right-click ▸ **Scale...**, or delete it; it prints and exports with the sheet.

20.9 Sheet tab

- **Sheet Properties**: size, orientation, scale, first or third angle.
- **Title Block** (Drawing Properties): title block fields, text height and decimals.
- **Units**: click **MMGS / IPS** in the status bar. An inch drawing gives lengths in inches with three decimals and its title block says "in"; angles are not converted.
- **Change Template**: see Drawing templates above.
- **Add Sheet**: drawings can have several sheets, shown as tabs under the sheet.
- **Export PDF**: vector PDF, one page per sheet.
- **Export DXF**: the current sheet as a DXF file, with layers for visible, thin, hidden and centre lines, text and hatching. A sheet format's logo is left out.

20.10 Views follow the part

Views and dimensions follow changes to the part or assembly, whether it is open in another tab or read from its file. A copy of the part is kept in the drawing so it still opens if the part file is missing.

20.11 Not yet available

DWG import and export: DWG is a closed format with no free reader or writer that could run in RazorCAD, so drawings are exported, and DXF files placed, as DXF, which practically every CAD program reads and writes.

21 Evaluate and Tools

21.1 Measure

Evaluate ▸ Measure, **Tools ▸ Measure...** or the view's right-click menu. Click vertices, edges, faces, planes or sketch lines; with two items picked it shows the distance between them plus dX, dY and dZ. Use the body filter (**B**) to pick whole bodies. Sizes are in the document's units.

- **Snap To**: besides vertices, a click picks **sketch points**, the **midpoints of edges** and the **centres of circles and arcs** (a hole's centre too); each can be turned off. As you move, the point a click would pick is marked on the model with its name.
- The items picked are numbered **1** and **2** on the model.
- **Keep the first item** measures from the first item to each next click (a third click replaces the second, not the first).
- **Measured** lists the distances measured so far, most recent first.

21.2 Mass Properties

Evaluate ▸ Mass Properties shows mass, volume, surface area and centre of mass. It adds up every body with its own density and lists the bodies. A body with no material uses 1.00 g/cm³.

21.3 Interference Check

Evaluate ▸ Interference Check finds where the solid bodies of a part overlap. It lists each pair with its overlap volume and shows the overlaps in red. Assemblies have their own (see the Assemblies chapter).

21.4 Surface analysis

These displays colour the model to show the quality of its faces. Click the button again to turn its display off.

Command	Shows
Zebra Stripes	Reflected stripes on every body. Across a smooth join the stripes run on without a kink.
Curvature	Bodies coloured from blue (flat) through green and yellow to red (tightest). The status bar gives the radius red stands for.
Draft Analysis	Choose a pull direction (an axis or a selected face's normal) and the draft needed. Faces turn green with enough draft, yellow where they need more, and red with draft the other way.

21.5 Configurations

Evaluate ▸ Configurations opens the design table (see the Configurations chapter).

21.6 Equations and global variables

Tools ▸ Equations... holds global variables that can be used in any dimension or feature value. Example: `width = 120`, then set a depth to `width/4`. Each row shows the value it evaluates to; invalid or duplicate names are flagged.

Every value field accepts:

Item	Examples
Operators	`+ - * / ^ %` and parentheses
Variables	Any name from Equations
Trigonometry (degrees)	`sin cos tan asin acos atan`
Other functions	`sqrt abs min max round floor ceil pow`
Constants	`pi`
Units of length	`2in`, `30 mm`, `1.5cm`, `2ft`, `(w/2)*in` (see Units)

A value may start with `=`. Variable names start with a letter or underscore and can't be a function name.

21.7 Macros

Tools ▸ Macros... writes, runs and saves JavaScript macros that drive RazorCAD.

- In parts they can sketch (lines, rectangles, circles, arcs, polygons), extrude, cut, revolve, add any feature, change or delete features, set equations and the material, and rebuild. In assemblies and drawings they can add, change and remove components, mates, views and annotations.
- Anywhere they can run any command by its name in the command search, ask you for a value, and run other macros.
- The **API** button lists what a macro can use; a sample macro shows the idea.
- A macro's changes are one undo step. Errors show their line, which is selected in the editor. **`Ctrl+Enter`** runs; **`Ctrl+S`** saves.

Tools ▸ Record Macro records what you do until **Stop Recording Macro** (or the red "● Recording macro" in the status bar): the features you add, change, delete or reorder, the commands you run, and in assemblies and drawings what you change there (parts inserted, components moved, mates, views, annotations, sheets). The recording opens in the Macros dialog to be saved or edited. Items made during the recording are kept in variables and others are found by name, so a recording plays back into another part, assembly or drawing.

Saved macros are in the Tools menu (**Macro: name**) and the command search, so they can have keyboard shortcuts. **Import...** / **Export...** share them as .js files.

> **Warning:** Macros can do anything RazorCAD can. Run only macros you trust.

21.8 Edit Material

Tools ▸ Edit Material... (or the Material item in the tree) sets the part material. See Appendix B for the list.

22 Modelling with Claude

RazorCAD can build features from a plain-language description using Anthropic's Claude.

22.1 Setting up

Open **Tools** ▸ **Claude Settings...** (or the Claude tab ▸ **Claude Settings**) and choose how RazorCAD reaches Claude:

- **My Claude subscription (Claude Code on this PC)**: each request goes through the Claude Code command-line program installed on this PC, signed in to your own Claude Pro or Max plan. It counts toward that plan's usage limits, with no separate bill. The dialog shows where Claude Code was found, its version and whether it is signed in; **Sign In...** starts the sign-in, which you finish in the browser, and **Check Again** reads the status again. Claude Code runs with no tools, settings or memory, from an empty folder, so it sees only RazorCAD's modelling guide and your request.
- **An Anthropic API key**: enter your own key (create one at console.anthropic.com ▸ API Keys; requests are billed to that account). The key is stored on this PC in `%APPDATA%\RazorCAD\claude.json` and is only sent to api.anthropic.com. **Remove Key** deletes it.

Then choose a model: Opus, Sonnet or Haiku.

22.2 Ask Claude panel

Open it with the **Claude** tab ▸ **Ask Claude**, or **Tools** ▸ **Ask Claude...**.

- Describe a part or a change. Claude adds the features to the tree; each answer is **one undo step**.
- If the features don't build, Claude is told the error and corrects it, up to two more tries.
- Claude sees the feature list and body sizes of the part, not the picture.
- **New Conversation** (or **New chat** in the panel) starts fresh; the part stays as it is.
- The model can be switched in the panel.

22.3 RazorCAD Part Builder on claude.ai

A companion page on claude.ai lets you describe a part, see the feature list with sketch previews, and download it as a .rcad file to open in RazorCAD. It uses the same modelling guide as the in-app panel.

23 Troubleshooting

23.1 Crash reports

RazorCAD writes a crash report whenever something goes wrong, to `%APPDATA%\RazorCAD\crashes\<date_time>_<kind>\`. Open the folder with **Help ▸ Open Crash Reports Folder**. The start window mentions new reports. The newest 30 are kept.

File	Contents
`report.json`	The kind of failure, the error message and stack trace, what RazorCAD was doing (mode, Property panel, sketch tool, selection, feature errors) and system information
`session.log`	The recent actions of the session, newest last
`part.rcad`	The part that was open, so the problem can be reproduced

Kinds of report: `ui-error`, `kernel-error`, `kernel-worker-crash`, `python-exception`, `native-crash` and `unexpected-shutdown` (a session that ended without closing normally, found at the next launch).

23.2 Reporting a problem

Help ▸ Report a Problem..., or **Report on GitHub...** in the start window's crash notice, turns a crash report (or a plain description, without a crash) into a GitHub issue. The report holds RazorCAD's version, Windows, what went wrong and the last lines of the session log; you see the whole text first and can edit it. Your user name and folders are taken out, and the part you were working on is not included. **Open GitHub Issue** opens RazorCAD's new-issue page in your browser with the text filled in; nothing is sent until you submit it there. **Copy Text** copies it instead.

23.3 Speed on your PC

How many geometry kernels work at once comes from the PC RazorCAD runs on: one per processor thread beyond two (left for the window and the rest of the PC), and about 1 GB of free memory each beyond 2 GB, read from Windows when RazorCAD starts; at least 2, at most 16. Assemblies build their parts side by side in them, drawings draw their views in them, and each open part keeps one (up to half of them). Kernels that are idle for a few minutes are stopped to give their memory back. A big imported STEP file's bodies are meshed by several kernels at once when that is quicker (64 bodies with 6784 faces: 1.8 s instead of 5.4 s). Crash reports note the figures, for example "up to 12 at once (24 threads, 14.8 GB free)".

Each open part's kernel is **multi-threaded**: Open CASCADE splits booleans (cuts, joins and the features built on them) and meshing over several threads, half the processor threads beyond two, from 2 to 8; more don't make it faster, only slower to start. A part full of cuts builds markedly faster (a sheet metal tray in 2.0 s instead of 4.5 s, the Giant Golfball in 4.7 s instead of 6.0 s); small parts are about the same. A PC with fewer than 6 threads keeps the single-thread kernel. The browser version at razorcad.com/app does the same in a current browser (the website serves it cross-origin isolated, which shared memory needs). The kernels for assemblies and drawings stay single-threaded, since they already work on several parts side by side. The session log says which kernel started ("Geometry kernel ready: multi-threaded, 8 threads").

Cuts made together: a run of cut features (extrude and revolve cuts with a blind, mid-plane or through end, holes other than tapped ones, and patterns and mirrors of cuts) is made in one boolean instead of one after another, each on a body with more faces than the last. The cuts wait until a feature needs the body as it really is (a fillet, a hole ending on a face, anything that picks model geometry) or the rebuild ends. The Giant Golfball (178 dimples) rebuilds in 2.5 s instead of 4.7 s, with exactly the same result. Editing

the last cut feature makes only its own cut again: the rest is remembered.

Editing a feature meshes again only the faces and edges it changed, and a part reopened from the model cache picks up where it left off without being built again.

23.4 Common problems

Problem	What to do
A fillet or projected edge loses its edge after a big change	Edges are found again by their geometry and the faces beside them (see References that follow edits). If one is still lost, **Tools ▸ Fix References** lists it: Edit to re-pick it, or Remove missing.
A mate moved to the wrong face, or shows a red !	Mates find their faces again by geometry. A face that is gone is listed in **Tools ▸ Fix Mates**: edit the mate to pick it again.
A sketch on a model face doesn't follow the face	Sketches on faces are stored as fixed planes. Use a reference plane driven by an equation when that matters.
Project Edges can't see a sketch	It only sees visible sketches earlier in the history. Show the sketch first.
An STL body can't be filleted	STL bodies with thousands of faces can't be filleted or chamfered and don't offer pickable edges.
A fillet won't blend across two touching bodies	Combine the bodies first.
Open fails with a file filter error	Fixed in 0.9.0-beta. Update RazorCAD.
Unsaved work after a crash	Reopen the part and accept the auto-save recovery.

23.5 Settings and data files

Location	Contents
`%APPDATA%\RazorCAD\recent.json`	Recent files list
`%APPDATA%\RazorCAD\claude.json`	Claude settings, API key and model
`%APPDATA%\RazorCAD\prefs.json`	Toolbar layout, icon size, your keyboard shortcuts, whether the tour was taken, and other preferences
`%APPDATA%\RazorCAD\update.json`	The update check: on or off, when it last looked, a version you chose to skip
`%APPDATA%\RazorCAD\crashes\`	Crash reports
`%LOCALAPPDATA%\RazorCAD\modelcache\`	Built models of parts and assemblies, and the geometry after each feature, for fast opening and editing, one folder per version of the geometry kernel (up to 1 GB; safe to delete)
`Documents\RazorCAD\Templates\`	Your drawing templates
`Name.autosave.rcad`	Auto-save, next to the part file

24 For Developers

24.1 Rebuilding the executable

```
python -m pip install pywebview pyinstaller pillow
build.bat
```

`build.bat` bundles `app/` (including the 23 MB OpenCascade WebAssembly kernel) and `razorcad.py` into `RazorCAD.exe` with PyInstaller. If RazorCAD is open, the running copy is renamed to `RazorCAD.old.exe` and the new build is used from the next launch.

`installer\build_installer.bat` builds `RazorCAD.exe` and then `RazorCAD-Setup.exe`. Set the version in `version.txt` first.

24.2 Code signing

Both builds sign RazorCAD.exe, the thumbnail DLL and the setup once a code-signing certificate is set up; until then they say "Not signed" and carry on. `tools\sign.py --check` shows how signing is set up. `installer\SIGNING.md` explains how to get a certificate and set it up (a certificate on a USB token or in Windows by its thumbprint, a .pfx file, or a cloud signing service).

24.3 Regression tests

```
python tests/run_tests.py
```

This rebuilds the test parts in `tests/parts` with the real geometry kernel in headless Microsoft Edge. It compares every body's volume, area, faces and edges (and flat patterns) with `tests/expected.json`, and the drawings of six test parts with their stored line counts and sizes. It also runs checks done as a user does them: sketching, dimensioning and extruding, drawings, assemblies, mates, references, standard parts, collisions, assembly features, macros, accessibility and more. It needs Python's playwright package and exits with 1 on any difference. `--update` stores new expected results, `--only` runs some of them, and `--make-parts` makes the test parts again from `tests/make_parts.js`. On a PC with 12 or more processor threads the run is split over several pages side by side (`--jobs N`; `--jobs 1` runs everything in one page): about 27 s instead of 65 s on 24 threads. See `tests/README.md`.

- **Timings**: every run's times are kept per machine in `tests/perf-history.json` (not in git). A test markedly slower than its usual time is listed under **Performance**; `--perf` lists every time and `--perf-strict` fails the run on a slowdown.
- **On GitHub** the tests run for every push and pull request (`.github/workflows/tests.yml`).

24.4 Releases

Pushing a version tag (for example `v0.14.0-beta`, matching `version.txt`) runs `.github/workflows/release.yml`: the tests, then RazorCAD.exe and the setup are built and a draft release is made with the setup, its read-me, checksums and notes from `CHANGELOG.md` (`tools/release_notes.py`). A version that already has a release is left alone. See `installer/RELEASING.md`.

24.5 The geometry kernel builds

`app/vendor/replicad` holds two builds of the same Open CASCADE bindings from replicad (commit a0bc495): `replicad_single` (one thread) and `replicad_multi` (threads, with shared memory). The kernel worker loads the multi-threaded one when the app asks for more than one thread and the page is cross-origin isolated: the desktop app's server, `serve.py` and the tests' server send `Cross-Origin-Opener-Policy: same-origin` and `Cross-Origin-Embedder-Policy: require-corp` for that. `tools/patch_replicad_multi.py` makes RazorCAD's changes to the published `replicad_multi.js`. The browser version leaves the multi-threaded build out.

24.6 The website and the browser version

`python tools/build_website_docs.py` builds the online manual (`website/docs`) from this manual's source and the browser version (`tools/build_web_app.py`). The browser version is built in its own folder, `RazorCAD Web` next to the project folder, with both kernels (`website/_headers` serves it cross-origin isolated, so it runs the multi-threaded one where the browser can), and copied from there into `website/app`; it carries the geometry kernel's signature so the browser keeps stored models per kernel.

`python tools/check_site.py` checks the website as it is served (razorcad.com, or another address): its pages, the browser version's isolation headers, and the browser version itself in headless Edge (it starts, and a multi-threaded kernel builds a part). GitHub runs it after each push that changes the website (`.github/workflows/site-check.yml`).

24.7 Working on the UI

Run `python serve.py` and open http://localhost:8765/ in a browser. In that mode files are downloaded instead of saved through dialogs. Set the `RAZORCAD_DATA_DIR` environment variable to keep a test run's recent-files list separate from your own.

24.8 Project layout

Path	Purpose
`RazorCAD.exe`	The application (built by build.bat)
`razorcad.py`	Desktop shell: native window, file dialogs, auto-save (pywebview)
`app/js/main.js`	Application controller: documents, commands, selection, files
`app/js/ui.js`	Menus, Command ribbon, Feature tree, Property panel, dialogs
`app/js/model.js`	Feature definitions, undo history, materials, sample part
`app/js/kernel.worker.js`	Geometry kernel worker: replays the history with OpenCascade
`app/js/sketcher.js`, `sketchmodel.js`, `solver.js`	Sketch mode, sketch data and the constraint solver
`app/js/sketch3d.js`, `sketch3dmodel.js`	3D sketches
`app/js/sheetmetal.js`	Sheet metal features and flat patterns
`app/js/weldments.js`, `profiles.js`	Fast Structure members and the profile tables
`app/js/assembly.js`, `asmview.js`, `explode.js`	Assemblies, their display and exploded views
`app/js/drawing*.js`, `drawtemplates.js`, `pdf.js`, `dxf.js`	Drawings, templates, sheet formats, PDF and DXF export

Path	Purpose
`app/js/claudespec.js`	Modelling guide used by Ask Claude
`app/js/collide.js`, `asmfeatures.js`, `asmcuts.js`, `motion.js`, `stdparts.js`	Collision detection, assembly holes and cuts, motion studies, standard parts
`app/js/macros.js`, `drawcheck.js`, `autodim.js`, `compare.js`	Macros, Check Drawing, Auto Dimension, Compare With
`app/js/a11y.js`, `machine.js`, `kernelclient.js`	Keyboard use and screen-reader labels; how many kernels the PC can run; the kernels
`kernelsig.py`	The geometry kernel's signature (the model cache is kept per kernel)
`Manual/`	This manual: source, build script and change tracking

Appendix A: Keyboard and Mouse Reference

General

Action	Keys
New / Open / Save	**Ctrl+N** / **Ctrl+O** / **Ctrl+S**
Save As	**Ctrl+Shift+S**
Import STEP / STL	**Ctrl+I**
Undo / Redo	**Ctrl+Z** / **Ctrl+Y**
Rebuild	**Ctrl+B**
Delete feature or entity	**Del**
Accept / cancel Property panel	**Enter** / **Esc**
Edit a feature	Double-click it in the tree
Search commands	**Ctrl+K** or **/**
Your own shortcuts	Help ▸ Customize Shortcuts
Focus to the panel, ribbon or view	**F6** / **Shift+F6**
In a tree: move / close or open / open the item / first or last	↑ ↓ / ← → / **Enter** / **Home End**

View

Action	Keys
Zoom to fit	**F**
Front, Back, Left, Right, Top, Bottom, Isometric	**Ctrl+1** … **Ctrl+7**
Normal To	**Ctrl+8**
Rotate in steps	Arrows 15°, **Shift** + arrows 90°
Pan in steps	**Ctrl** + arrows
Roll	**Alt** + ← / →
Hide body under cursor / show hidden body under cursor	**Tab** / **Shift+Tab**

Selection filters

Filter	Key
Faces / Edges / Vertices / Bodies	**X** / **E** / **V** / **B**
Clear filters	**F5**

Sketch

Tool	Key
Select	**S**

Tool	Key
Line	**L**
Rectangle	**R**
Circle	**C**
Arc	**A**
Spline	**N**
Polygon	**P**
Trim	**T**
Dimension	**D**
Project Edges	**E**
Offset	**O**
Construction Geometry	**Q**
Delete	**Del**
End tool, then exit sketch	**Esc**
Tool wheel	Hold the right button (or drag with it)

3D sketch

Action	Keys
Next drawing plane (XY → YZ → ZX), or back from a picked plane	**Tab**
Draw off the X/Y/Z directions	Hold **Ctrl** or **Shift**
Draw on a plane or flat face	**Ctrl**+click it
Length dimension: true length → ΔX → ΔY → ΔZ	**Tab** while placing
Tools	Same keys as 2D sketches: **S**, **L**, **C**, **A**, **N**, **P**, **D**, **T**, **E**, **Q**

Assembly

Action	Keys
Mate	**M**
Move a component / turn it	Left-drag / **Alt**+drag
Motion study: play / stop	**Space**
Zoom to fit	**F**

Appendix B: Materials

Material	Density (g/cm³)
Plain Carbon Steel	7.80
AISI 304 Stainless	8.00
6061 Aluminum Alloy	2.70
Brass	8.50
Copper	8.96
Ti-6Al-4V	4.43
ABS Plastic	1.04
PLA Plastic	1.24
Nylon 6/6	1.14

A body or part with no material uses 1.00 g/cm³ for mass calculations.

Appendix C: Manual Revision History

Date	Software version	Changes
2026-10-26	0.17.4-beta	Settings window. Variable fillet points dragged along their edges. Assemblies keep their own up axis. Sketch Fillet where a spline meets a line or an arc. Feature folders, and patterns of them. Developed sheets: the neutral layer on the inside of each face's curve. An experimental Linux build.
2026-10-26	0.17.3-beta	Lofted Surface guide curves (rails). Patterns of more features, faces and bodies. Measure snaps (sketch points, midpoints, centres), numbered picks, keep the first item, history. Refused relations say why. Guided Loft follows its guides more closely; Bézier profile reversal and the Lofted Surface closed check fixed. Contributions merged: parametric sketch patterns with a side panel, draggable dimension labels, Equal Curve Length and Coincident Midpoints relations, loft profiles and guides picked on the model, grouped sketch tools and slots, parameter autocomplete.
2026-10-25	0.17.2-beta	Edge-Flange: corners corner to corner with square ends by default (each flange to the other's inside face, gap 0.5 mm, bends in straight V cuts); mitred kept as an option; no split or sliver faces at the corners. Up axis Y or Z per part (View, status bar, the Origin's right-click menu). Variable fillets: points along the edges. Rips as one cut line. Sketch box selection, splines to degree 7, Sketch Fillet on arcs, sketch patterns along a curve, plane references from sketch entities. An example part and a tutorial. One file dialog at a time.
2026-10-25	0.17.1-beta	Edge-Flange: flanges meet corner to corner by default. Control-point splines: closed smoothly, weights, control points inserted and removed, splines converted. Loft guide curves move holes and thin walls too. Convert to Sheet Metal: flanges flush against the material beside them ripped; a wrapped blade unrolled.
2026-10-24	0.17.0-beta	Control-Point Spline (degree 1 to 5, its polygon dimensioned and constrained). Midpoint of an arc. Reference planes: through an edge and a point, through two edges, at a distance along an edge, tangent to a cylindrical face; placement for every plane. Loft guide curves. Convert to Sheet Metal: square-to-round transitions, cones and closed tubes unrolled, exact corners. Section views saved with the part. STEP, IGES and mesh files opened from Windows are imported.
2026-10-21	0.16.0-beta	Section view: from a selected face or plane, a drag arrow, in assemblies, two or three planes at once. The view turns about the point under the cursor. Big imports kept and read back quicker; Measure quicker on sheet metal.
2026-10-21	0.15.0-beta	Speed on your PC: the multi-threaded geometry kernel and cuts made together. For Developers: the kernel builds; the browser version built in its own folder.
2026-10-21	0.14.0-beta	New sections: RazorCAD in your browser, Update Now, Language and theme, Using the keyboard, Properties, Compare With, IGES import, Etch Lines, Standard parts, Collision detection, Equations shared with the parts, Assembly holes and cuts, Motion studies, Speed Mode, assembly STEP export, Auto Dimension, Check Drawing, DXF drawings on the sheet, Macros, Reporting a problem, Speed on your PC, Releases and the website. Updated: bill of materials columns, mass and cost; fillets set at each vertex and setback corners; curvature-continuous 3D splines and loft continuity; the fonts that come with RazorCAD; the model cache; tests.
2026-10-20	0.13.0-beta	New sections: Updates, Getting Started Tour, Search commands, Your own keyboard shortcuts, Units (inches), Cosmetic Thread, References that follow edits, Fix References, gear and rack-pinion mates, Fix Mates, assembly Interference Check, Code signing and Regression tests. Drawings add Balloon and BOM Table, exploded views and units; Hole callouts give cosmetic threads. Faster opening (the geometry after each feature is kept) and faster patterns of added features.

Date	Software version	Changes
2026-10-20	0.12.0-beta	Brought up to date with the software. New chapters: 3D Sketches, Airfoils, Fast Structure, Configurations and Assemblies. Sheet Metal adds Sheet Metal Extrude, Lofted Bend, Transition / Reducer, Miter Flange, Hem, Sketched Bend, Jog, Cross Break, Tab and Slot, Forming Tools, Gusset, gauge tables and Sheet Metal Check. Drawings add templates, auxiliary, break and crop views, baseline, ordinate and chamfer dimensions, hole callouts, GD&T, surface finish and weld symbols, revision and cut list tables, bend tables and DXF export. Surfaces add lofted, swept, filled, boundary and ruled surfaces, trim, extend, untrim, delete and replace face, split line, projected and composite curves, flatten surface, convert to solid and repair mesh. Also: new sketch tools, Hole, Draft, Rib, Dome, Move Face, Scale, new patterns, appearances, exploded views, interference check, surface analysis, OBJ and 3MF, toolbar customising and the Claude subscription option. Feature and tool names follow the software's new names.
2026-10-13	0.9.0-beta	First edition. Covers parts, sketching, gears, solid features, bodies, surfaces, reference geometry, the feature tree, sheet metal (including Convert to Sheet Metal with detected thickness and bend radii), drawings, evaluate tools, Ask Claude, troubleshooting and developer notes.

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